

CITY: Pg 3

Keeping Delhi clean, attractive & vibrant remains our priority: CM



NATION: Pg 5

LS fails to take up resolution on Birla's removal as Speaker



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Wouldn't want to go back to that time: Katie Leung



SUPPLY FEARS: OIL TOPS \$100 A BARREL AS WAR ESCALATES
Iran picks new leader; war, oil surge

Putin congratulates new supreme leader, reaffirms unwavering support to Tehran



People gather in a rally to support Ayatollah Mojtaba Khamenei, the successor to his late father Ayatollah Ali Khamenei as supreme leader, in Tehran, Iran, Monday

AP/PTI

NO LET-UP

- » The US and Israel on Monday continued to bombard Iran, with explosions reported in Qom and Tehran, hours after Israeli attacks on oil facilities caused toxic smoke across the Iranian capital
- » The younger Khamenei, who has not been seen in public since the war started, was long considered a potential successor — even before the Israeli strike killed his 86-year-old father
- » His wife, Zahra Haddad Adel, was killed in the same strike
- » The threat of Iranian missile and drone attacks has all but stopped tankers carrying oil and gas from Saudi Arabia, Kuwait, Iraq, Qatar, Bahrain, the United Arab Emirates and Iran from traveling through the strait, which is bordered in the north by Iran

» ISRAEL SAYS 1 KILLED IN IRANIAN MISSILE ATTACK; WAR DEATH TOLL RISES TO 11

No inflation threat

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The impact of global crude price rise on inflation is not estimated to be substantial at this point as India's inflation is near the lower bound, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said on Monday. In reply to a written question in the Lok Sabha, Sitharaman said the price of both global crude oil and the Indian basket has been on a declining trajectory for the past one year, till the geo-political clashes commenced in West Asia on February 28, 2026. "Between the end of February and until March 2, 2026, the Crude Oil FOB Price (Indian Basket) rose from \$69.01/barrel to \$80.16/barrel. Given that India's inflation is near the lower bound, the impact on inflation is not estimated to be substantial at this point," Sitharaman said. **See P9**

Relief: No fuel hike

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Petrol and diesel prices will not be increased for now despite international crude oil rates crossing \$100 per barrel, top government sources said on Monday. Officials said the government is closely monitoring global oil markets, but there is no immediate plan to raise retail fuel prices. Oil marketing companies are expected to absorb the current cost pressure for the time being. **See P9**

Crude oil chaos hits Dalal Street

Silver slides, gold stays flat

MPOST BUREAU

MUMBAI: Indian equity benchmarks ended Monday's session off their intraday lows after crude oil prices retreated sharply from earlier highs, easing some pressure on global markets. The Nifty 50 closed 1.74 per cent lower near the 24,000 mark, while the Sensex ended nearly 1,400 points lower around 77,500 after a volatile trading session.

Both indices had fallen much more sharply earlier in the day as the surge in oil prices and global market weakness triggered risk aversion among investors. The Sensex had dropped as much as 2,994 points, or 3.2 per cent, to an intraday low of 76,424.55, while the Nifty declined as much as 3.1 per cent to 23,597 before recovering part of the losses.

Oil prices pulled back sharply after a historic intraday surge earlier in the day. Brent crude traded at \$103.22 per barrel, up \$10.53 or 11.36 per cent, while US benchmark crude slipped below the \$100 mark to \$99.97, gaining \$9.07 or 9.98 per cent. Prices had earlier surged in what marked the largest intraday jump on record. Brent had climbed as much as 29.92 per cent to \$119.50 per barrel, while US crude rose as much as 31.44 per cent to \$119.48 before reversing.

Soaring crude oil prices and weak global trends due to the worsening situation in West Asia contributed to trigger a sharp sell-off in the stock market.

Besides, unabated foreign fund exodus and the weak-



KEY POINTS

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THE RUPEE CRASHED TO ITS ALL-TIME CLOSING LOW OF 92.21 AGAINST THE US DOLLAR ON MONDAY, LOSING 39 PAISE DURING THE SESSION

ness in the rupee against the US dollar weighed heavily on investors' sentiment, traders said. A total of 3,379 stocks declined, while 972 advanced and 185 remained unchanged on the BSE. **Continued on P4**

ASSOCIATED PRESS

DUBAI: Iran named the hard-line Ayatollah Mojtaba Khamenei to succeed his late father as supreme leader on Monday, signalling no letup in the war launched by the United States and Israel. Oil prices surged as Iran attacked regional energy infrastructure and the US and Israel bombed targets across Iran. The secretive 56-year-old cleric has close ties to the paramilitary Revolutionary Guard, which has been firing missiles and drones at Israel and Gulf Arab states since Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, who had ruled Iran

Report links US to school strike that killed 165

JERUSALEM: The investigative group Bellingcat says the newly released video "appears to contradict" US President Donald Trump's claim that Iran was responsible for an explosion at an Iranian school that killed over 165 people at the start of the war raging in the Mideast.

It comes as mounting evidence points to US culpability for the Feb. 28 strike, which hit a school adjacent to a Revolutionary Guard base in Minab, Iran, in the country's southern Hormozgan Province. Experts interviewed by The Associated Press, citing satellite image analysis, say the school was likely struck amid a quick succession of bombs dropped on the compound.

The video shared by Bellingcat is a three-second clip of a video taken the day the school was struck and circulated Sunday by Iran's semi-official Mehr news agency. **See P10**

a fight for the Islamic theocracy's survival.

The US and Israel on Monday continued to bombard Iran, with explosions reported in Qom and Tehran, hours after Israeli attacks on oil facilities caused toxic smoke across the Iranian capital.

Iran's Foreign Ministry spokesman Esmail Baghaei said the attacks aimed "at partitioning our country to take illegal possession of our oil riches".

The younger Khamenei, who has not been seen in public since the war started, was long considered a potential successor — even **Continued on P4**

for 37 years, was killed during the war's opening salvo. The appointment marked

a new sign of defiance by Iran's embattled leadership after more than a week of heavy US

and Israeli bombardment, suggesting Tehran is not close to giving up on what it considers

Excise case: HC seeks Kejriwal, Sisodia stand

NEW DELHI: The Delhi High Court on Monday sought the stand of former Delhi chief minister Arvind Kejriwal, his deputy Manish Sisodia and 21 others on a petition by the CBI challenging their discharge in the liquor policy case by the trial court. Justice Swarana Kanta Sharma issued notice to all the accused people and listed the CBI's petition for hearing on March 16. **See P3**

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PM speaks to Nepal's RSP leaders after win

Backs progress and partnership

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Monday spoke to leaders of the Rastriya Swatantra Party (RSP) of Nepal Rabi Lamichhane and Balendra Shah and congratulated them for their election victory and conveyed India's commitment to work with them for mutual prosperity, progress and well-being of the two countries.

In his telephonic conversations with the two leaders of Nepal, PM Modi said he was confident that with the joint endeavours, India-Nepal relations will scale new heights in the coming years.

"Had warm telephone conversations with Mr. Rabi Lamichhane, Chairman of the Rastriya Swatan-

tra Party (RSP) and Mr. Balendra Shah, Senior Leader of the RSP," he said in a post on 'X'.

The prime minister said he congratulated both leaders on their electoral victories and RSP's resounding success in the Nepal elections.

"Conveyed my best wishes for their forthcoming new Government and India's commitment to work with them for mutual prosperity, progress and well-being of our two countries," he said.

The House of Representatives (HoR) in Nepal has a total of 275 seats. While 165 members are elected through the First Past The Post (FPTP) or direct voting system, 110 members are elected through proportional representation. **Continued on P4**



AS KUNO WELCOMES FIVE CUBS

India's cheetah count: 53

MPOST BUREAU

BHOPAL: India's cheetah population crossed the 50-mark on Monday after the birth of five cubs to Namibian cheetah 'Jwala' at Madhya Pradesh's Kuno National Park, bringing the national total to 53.

The announcement was made by Union Environment Minister Bhupendra Yadav, who noted that this development comes just days after another cheetah, Gamini, gave birth to four cubs in the same reserve.

The birth of Jwala's quintuplets represents a major victory for 'Project Cheetah' and the success of the country's cheetah reintroduction efforts.

"With this birth, the number of Indian-born thriving cubs has risen to 33, marking the 10th successful cheetah litter on Indian soil -- another important milestone in India's cheetah conservation journey," Yadav said in a post on X.



A cheetah named Jwala rests with her cubs after giving birth at Kuno National Park

The minister said the achievement reflected the dedicated efforts, skills, and commitment of the veterinarians, field staff and all involved who continue to work tirelessly on the ground.

SPOTTED SUCCESS

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- » The birth of Jwala's quintuplets represents a major victory for 'Project Cheetah' and the success of the country's cheetah reintroduction efforts

Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav hailed the achievement as a "proud moment" for wildlife conservation, describing the population surge as a strong testament to the success **Continued on P4**

Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav hailed the achievement as a "proud moment" for wildlife conservation, describing the population surge as a strong testament to the success **Continued on P4**

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India on Monday advocated de-escalation of tensions in West Asia and called for dialogue and diplomacy to resolve all underlying issues, as it put the safety of around one crore Indians in the region as its top priority, along with securing energy security and trade.

Making a suo-motu statement in Parliament, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar said New Delhi stood for maintaining the sovereignty and territorial integrity of all states in the region. He defended allowing the Iranian ship to dock at an Indian port as the right decision taken on humanitarian grounds.

He said the Indian government has been constantly monitoring the evolving situation in the region at the highest level and has already brought back



External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar, left, speaks in the Rajya Sabha

67,000 stranded Indians from the conflict zone.

Jaishankar said the safety of Indian nationals and national interests, such as energy security and trade, remain the topmost priority for the government.

"India is in favour of peace and urges a return to dialogue

DELHI'S LINE

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GOLDEN HOUR



Boats sail on the Yamuna River as the sun sets behind the cable-stayed Yamuna Bridge, in Prayagraj

Sharjeel Imam gets 10-day interim bail

NEW DELHI: A Delhi court on Monday granted 10-day interim bail on several conditions to activist Sharjeel Imam, an accused in the 2020 Delhi riots case, to attend a family event.

Imam has been asked not to meet anyone except his friends, relatives or family members, or visit places except those mentioned in his

plea. He has also been prohibited from using social media.

Additional Sessions Judge Sameer Bajpai was hearing the interim bail application filed by Imam, seeking relief for six weeks -- to attend his brother's wedding scheduled this month and spend time with family during the Eid festival. **See P2**

FAMILY: DRIVERS WERE RACING

DTC bus runs into vehicles; two dead

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Two persons were killed and two were critically injured when a speeding DTC bus, allegedly racing against another bus, hit pedestrians and multiple vehicles on a busy road in outer Delhi's Nihal Vihar on Monday morning, prompting a mob to vandalise vehicles and set ablaze a bus.

The accident, the police said, triggered violent protests during which an angry mob vandalised buses, pelted stones and set one vehicle on fire. However, no immediate response from the Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) was received.

The accident on the busy Najafgarh-Nangloi Road sparked chaos and tension in the area as hundreds of residents and family members gathered at the spot, alleging that two DTC buses, which had around 10 passengers onboard, were racing against each other.

The police said the driver, identified as Deepak, of the bus involved in the accident was apprehended and further investigation is underway. The deceased have been identified as Ravikant (32) and Kamaljeet (39), while a 20-year-old woman and a 23-year-old man, identified as Aman, were injured in the crash. They were rushed to Mansa Ram Hospital in Nihal Vihar, the police said.

Police sources said they are checking CCTV to confirm if the buses were involved in reckless driving or any techni-



A policeman inspects a burnt DTC bus after it hit multiple vehicles in Outer Delhi's Nangloi area, in New Delhi, on Monday

PI/CPTI

“Eyewitnesses alleged that the authorities did not respond to calls made immediately after the incident”

cal malfunction.

According to government data, public transport buses on Delhi's roads were involved in nearly 150 accidents during 2024-25, including about 40 fatal crashes.

Police said that they received a PCR call about the accident at 9.45 am. Initial information suggested that a DTC bus coming from the Najafgarh side had rammed into several vehicles, including a scooter and a motorcycle, and also hit pedestrians on the road.

“Two people have died in the incident, while a man and a woman sustained injuries and were rushed to a nearby hospi-

tal,” Deputy Commissioner of Police (Outer) Vikram Singh said in a statement.

He also said that two FIRs have been registered in the entire matter.

“One FIR has been registered against the DTC bus driver Deepak under charges of rash driving and acts endangering human life or personal safety and causing death by negligence. Another FIR has been registered against unidentified persons who were involved in damaging, stone pelting and torching the bus,” the statement read.

Witnesses and family members alleged the crash occurred as two buses were racing to reach the next stop first, with the speeding bus losing control while overtaking and ramming into vehicles. The incident triggered protests by around 500 locals, who vandalised buses and set one on fire. Police later brought the situation under control and apprehended the driver.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police has arrested seven more people and apprehended another minor in connection with the killing of a 26-year-old man during a clash between two families on Holi in south-west Delhi's Uttam Nagar, an official said on Monday.

With the latest arrests, the total number of people arrested in the case has gone up to 14. Two minors have also been apprehended.

Meanwhile, a senior police officer warned that those who are circulating misleading, AI-generated videos about the incident on social media will face action.

In the latest crackdown, three among those arrested are women, namely Sayra alias Kali (40), Sharifan (50) and Salma (36), all residents of Uttam Nagar. They were taken into custody earlier for questioning in connection with the incident, a senior police officer said.



“With the latest arrests, the total number of people arrested in the case has gone up to 14”

The other accused arrested include Suhail alias Sahil (21), Sameer Chauhan (20), Firoj (22) and Ismile (50), all residents of the same locality. Additionally, a 14-year-old minor has also been apprehended for his alleged role in the violence, police said.

According to police sources, Sayra alias Kali was the woman who allegedly got into an argument when a young girl

CM meets murder victim's family

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday met the family of 26-year-old Tarun Kumar, who was beaten to death on Holi in west Delhi's Uttam Nagar, and assured them of full government support and swift action.

The meeting took place at the Delhi Secretariat, where Gupta expressed condolences and said the govern-

ment stands firmly with the bereaved family. She described their loss as deeply painful and said ensuring justice for the victim remains the administration's top priority.

Gupta added that authorities have been directed to ensure the harshest and swiftest legal action against those involved and assured the family of continued assistance, support and protection from the Delhi government.

from the victim's family threw a water balloon that burst, splashing water on Kali who was passing by on the street.

Following this, a verbal altercation broke out between members of the two families, which eventually led to a violent clash in the densely populated JJ Colony area on March 4.

During the clash, several people allegedly attacked

Tarun (26), who sustained serious injuries. He was rushed to a hospital, where he succumbed to his injuries on March 5, police said.

The incident triggered tension in the locality, following which heavy deployment of police and paramilitary personnel was made in the area to maintain law and order.

Dwarka DCP Kushal Pal Singh said, “We have noticed

that some fake AI-generated videos are being widely spread on social media platforms about the entire incident. Our teams are checking all the videos and we are also identifying those who are behind them. Those who are spreading misinformation will also be arrested. The condition is totally peaceful in the area.”

He added that police teams are continuing efforts to identify and apprehend other individuals involved in the clash.

The officer further said they have divided the entire area in zones, sectors and sub-sectors.

The DCP said ACPs and SHOs were monitoring sectors and sub-sectors, with additional deployment of RAF, CRPF and district police personnel as the situation returned to normal. Investigation is underway.

Meanwhile, the Municipal Corporation of Delhi demolished “illegal portions” of a house linked to one accused, citing encroachment on drains.

Man caught for killing partner, her daughter

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police has arrested a 38-year-old man for the alleged murder of his 34-year-old live-in partner and her 9-year-old daughter following a quarrel.

The police were alerted about the incident through a PCR call received at the Radraprayag, Uttarakhand Police Station. The accused has been identified as Deepak Bahadur (38), son of Bal Bahadur, resident of Nepal.

According to the police, the accused was arrested while allegedly attempting to board a train to Mumbai. He was wanted in connection with an FIR dated March 7, registered under Section 103(1) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) at Rudraprayag Police Station.

After his apprehension, he was handed over to the Uttarakhand Police for further legal action and investigation.

The case came to light on March 6, when information was received at the Jakhole Police Outpost under Kotwali Rudraprayag from Yogendra Lal, a resident of Tilwada village. The informant reported that Bahadur, who had been living in a rented room with his 34-year-old partner and her nine-year-old daughter, had not been seen for several days and that a foul smell was emanating from the room.

Police found the decomposed bodies inside the locked room. The accused was later traced in Delhi and allegedly confessed during interrogation.

Man held for assault, acid attack on partner

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

GURUGRAM: A 30-year-old woman living in a live-in relationship in Gurugram was allegedly assaulted by her partner, who is also accused of throwing acid on her, police said. The accused, identified as Pawan, a resident of Jainabad in Rewari, Haryana, has been arrested by the Crime Branch of the Gurugram Police.

The incident came to light on the night of March 8 when Sector 10A police station received information from Civil Hospital, Sector 10, that a woman had arrived for treatment after allegedly being injured in an acid attack by an unknown person. A police team reached the hospital and obtained her medico-legal report. After doctors declared her fit to give a statement, her account was recorded.

The woman told police that she had come to Gurugram around four years ago in search of work and had

“Doctors discharged her the same day as her condition was stable”

been living with Pawan in a flat in Sector 72.

She alleged that on March 8, Pawan assaulted her and later threw acid on her while she was undergoing treatment at Civil Hospital, causing her clothes to burn. Based on her complaint, police registered a case related to the acid attack at Sector 10A police station, while another case related to assault was registered at Badshahpur PS.

After receiving initial treatment, the woman was referred to PGI Rohtak. However, following examination, doctors discharged her the same day as her condition was stable.

Crime Branch arrested the accused on March 9; one man and woman detained for questioning.

Manipuri woman beaten with belt by minor boys in city park

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A Manipuri woman has alleged that she was beaten with a belt and attacked with a knife after she objected to sexual and racial remarks by a group of boys in a south Delhi park.

The police have apprehended four juveniles in connection with the incident that took Sunday evening in south Delhi's Malviya Nagar near the Saket District Court Complex.

The woman and her friend had gone to the park for a walk and were taking pictures when around six to seven boys started teasing them with sexual slurs, the police said.

“When we objected and asked them to stop, the group allegedly became aggressive and called us ‘prostitutes’ while making racist remarks and using abusive Hindi slang,” the woman said in the complaint.

She alleged that the situation quickly escalated into violence. “They became aggressive



and started physically assaulting me. They did not stop even after beating me.”

She alleged that one of the attackers took out a knife and attempted to stab her, forcing her to run away from the spot.

“When I fell running, they took an iron belt and hit me on the back of my head, causing bleeding in my right ear,” she said. The woman alleged that she and her friend begged the attackers to stop, but the assault continued. “We were begging them not to beat us anymore. While we were running, we called for help, but nobody tried to stop the assault and

harassment on us,” she said.

The woman said she had never seen the attackers before. “For me, it was shocking: I do not know them, I saw them for the first time, how could they attack me in daylight!” she said, according to the complaint. The local SHO and other staff rushed to the spot and met the injured woman after a distress call, the police said.

They said the woman told them that some boys aged around 15 to 16 years were there in the park and began passing abusive remarks and sexual slurs. When she objected, they allegedly became aggressive and started quarrelling with her. According to the police, one of the accused hit the woman with a waist belt, causing minor injuries.

She was taken to Madan Mohan Malviya Hospital and later referred to Safdarjung Hospital. Police registered an FIR, apprehended four juveniles and recovered the belt used in the assault.

Delhi records warmer-than-usual day and night

NEW DELHI: Delhi recorded an unusually warm day on Monday, with temperatures significantly above normal across the city, according to the India Meteorological Department.

At Safdarjung, the city's base station, the maximum temperature reached 35.3 degrees Celsius, nearly 7 degrees above normal. Ridge recorded 36.1 degrees Celsius, followed by Anagar at 35.5 degrees Celsius and Lodhi Road at 35 degrees Celsius.

The Capital also saw its highest minimum temperature of the season at 19 degrees Celsius, about 5 degrees above normal. Palam recorded 18.8 degrees Celsius, while Lodhi Road logged 18.2 degrees Celsius. No rainfall was reported during the day. Meanwhile, the 24-hour average Air Quality Index stood at 209, remaining in the ‘poor’ category. MPOST

JNU student union announces referendum amid protest row

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Jawaharlal Nehru University Students' Union (JNUSU) has called for intensifying the ongoing student movement at Jawaharlal Nehru University, alleging administrative inaction and police repression during recent protests on campus.

In a statement issued, the union said that the past month had witnessed a series of protests led by students across various schools within the university. According to the union, the agitation began as a strike and later escalated into lockdowns in several academic blocks as students demanded implementation of University Grants Commission regulations, release of funds and action over alleged casteist remarks by the Vice-Chancellor.

The union alleged that several First Information Reports (FIRs) had been filed against

“Union criticised the univ admin for not issuing any statement condemning the police action during protests”

students for participating in protests and for decisions taken during general body meetings across schools. It further claimed that more than 50 students were detained by the police and 14 students were arrested for marching to the Ministry of Education to press their demands.

According to the statement, the arrested students were later released after spending three days in Tihar Jail. The union also criticised the university administration for not issuing any statement condemning the police action during the protests.

The JNUSU said it would organise further meetings and

discussions across schools to mobilise wider student participation and build consensus for the movement. As part of its next step, the union has called for a campus-wide referendum on March 10 to seek students' views regarding the future of the Vice-Chancellor.

The referendum, the union said, will be overseen by former members of the Jawaharlal Nehru University Teachers Association (JNUTA). The results are expected to be announced at a press conference scheduled to be held on March 11 at the Press Club of India.

The students' body also alleged that eviction notices were issued to some hostel residents linked to the protests and claimed that the administration had targeted the encampment site used by protesting students. The union has called on the wider student community to continue participating in the movement in the coming days.

NDMC begins cleanliness drive to make central areas dust-free

Mechanised sweepers, anti-smog guns part of campaign

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) on Monday launched an intensive sanitation campaign across its jurisdiction with the aim of making the national capital's central areas cleaner, greener and largely dust-free.

NDMC chairman Keshav Chandra said the campaign focuses on strengthening sanitation management, improving waste disposal and controlling dust pollution through coordinated efforts by various departments.

As part of the initiative, 14 heads of departments have been appointed as nodal officers, each responsible for supervising sanitation work in a designated circle. The officials will monitor field operations,



coordinate staff deployment and ensure daily reporting on cleanliness activities.

The chairman is also conducting regular visits to sanitation zones to review ground conditions and identify areas that require immediate attention. Resident Welfare Associations (RWAs) and Market Traders Associations (MTAs) are being informed about the schedules of mechanised

‘Campaign also includes removal of garbage and construction debris, cleaning of parks...’

road sweepers to ensure better coordination during cleaning operations.

According to NDMC officials, dry leaves collected from roads, markets, parks and residential areas constitute a large portion of daily waste during this season. Four mechanised road sweepers have been deployed to clean major avenues in two shifts, including night operations.

The collected leaves are processed into compost and later distributed to residents for gardening and horticulture purposes.

The campaign also includes removal of garbage and construction debris, cleaning of parks and underpasses, maintenance of footpaths and drains, pruning of trees and repainting of walls and public structures to improve the overall appearance of the city.

To reduce dust pollution, anti-smog guns, mist spray systems and water sprinkling through tankers using treated water are being deployed across NDMC roads. Officials said the campaign aims to strengthen environmental sustainability while encouraging citizens to actively participate in maintaining cleanliness in the city.

L-G, CM UNVEIL ‘SHRI PARTH-SARATHI RATH’

Keeping Delhi clean, attractive & vibrant remains our priority: CM

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Lieutenant Governor VK Saxena and Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday inaugurated the newly installed ‘Shri Parth-Sarathi Rath’ at Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg near Delhi Gate, an artistic structure developed by the Public Works Department (PWD) as part of efforts to enhance the city’s cultural landscape and beautify historic zones.

The installation, inspired by the depiction of Lord Krishna as Parth-Sarathi - the charioteer of Arjuna in the Mahabharata, has been designed as a landmark structure aimed at enriching the visual appeal of the historic Delhi Gate area.

Speaking at the inauguration, the Lieutenant Governor said the project reflects the administration’s commitment to improving the capital’s urban aesthetics. “Making



Artistic installations not only beautify public spaces but also become attractive landmarks for residents and visitors: L-G VK Saxena MPOST

Delhi a beautiful and well-organised city is our shared dream,” Saxena said, adding that the government continues to undertake development and beautification initiatives to achieve this goal.

Highlighting the effort behind the installation, Saxena said the project took several months of preparation and

dedication from the engineering and design teams. “The team worked continuously for nearly seven to eight months to create this impressive installation,” he said, congratulating the Public Works Department for completing the project.

The L-G noted that the structure has been designed for durability and is expected to

TAKEAWAYS

» Highlighting the effort behind the installation, Saxena said the proj took several months of preparation, dedication from the engineering and design teams

» ‘The team worked continuously for nearly 7-8 months to create this impressive installation,’ he said, congratulating the Public Works dept

ronment. “Keeping the capital clean, attractive and vibrant remains our priority,” she said.

Gupta added that the Delhi Gate-Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg area holds significant historical and cultural importance, and the concept of the Shri Parth-Sarathi Rath was developed keeping this heritage in mind.

The chariot structure, measuring about 30 feet by 20 feet and weighing around 5,500 kilograms, has been constructed using 10 mm thick 316-grade stainless steel plates. To illuminate the installation at night, 12 spotlights and 12 floodlights have been installed, while landscaping and horticulture work has also been carried out around the site to enhance its overall appearance.

Delhi Cabinet Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh and Jangpura MLA Tarvinder Singh Marwah were also present at the inauguration ceremony.

‘SOTTO to streamline organ donation, transplant system’

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a major step towards strengthening the organ donation and transplantation system in the capital, the Delhi government has signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the Centre under the National Organ Transplant Programme (NOTP) to establish a State Organ and Tissue Transplant Organisation (SOTTO).

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the agreement marks a significant milestone in improving the coordination and efficiency of organ transplantation in Delhi. “Organ donation will give many people a new lease on life, and a State Organ and Tissue Transplant Organisation will be established in Delhi,” she said.

Explaining the existing system, Gupta said organ transplantation in India currently operates under a three-tier framework created under the Transplantation of Human Organs and Tissues Act (THOTA), 1994 and the 2014 Rules. The system is managed nationally by the National



Organ and Tissue Transplant Organisation (NOTTO), while Regional Organ and Tissue Transplant Organisations (ROTTO) function at the regional level and SOTTOs operate at the state level.

She noted that many coordination tasks related to organ transplantation in Delhi had so far been handled through NOTTO, despite the capital having several transplant centres. The establishment of SOTTO will now create a dedicated state-level mechanism to manage organ donation and transplantation activities more efficiently.

“With SOTTO in place, the organ donation and transplant

system in Delhi will become more organised, transparent and efficient,” the Chief Minister said.

The organisation will streamline organ allocation and waiting list management, strengthen coordination between transplant hospitals and organ retrieval centres, promote deceased organ donation and facilitate the creation of green corridors for faster transportation of organs.

Gupta added that the Centre will provide financial assistance to establish and run SOTTO, including infrastructure support for offices and IT systems as well as grants for manpower and operational expenses. The Centre will also support awareness campaigns and training programmes for transplant coordinators and hospital staff.

“Government hospitals in Delhi will receive support to develop organ retrieval centres and transplant facilities, further strengthening the city’s transplant infrastructure,” she said, adding that the initiative will help ensure life-saving organs reach patients on time.

Taranjit Singh Sandhu to take oath as Delhi L-G on March 11

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi’s Lieutenant Governor designate Taranjit Singh Sandhu is scheduled to take oath of the office in a ceremony at Lok Niwas on March 11, officials said on Monday.

Sandhu, an experienced former diplomat will be administered oath as the national capital’s 23rd LG by the Delhi High Court chief justice.

The ceremony scheduled to be held at 1.30 pm on Wednesday, they said.

His predecessor Vinai Kumar Saxena has been appointed as the Lt Governor of Ladakh.

Preparations were underway for the oath ceremony at Lok Niwas (formerly Raj Niwas). Saxena is scheduled to take oath as Ladakh LG on Friday, officials said, adding that he was in the process of moving out.

HIGHLIGHTS

» Sandhu, an experienced former diplomat will be administered oath as the 23rd L-G by the Delhi High Court chief justice

» The ceremony scheduled to be held at 1.30 pm on Wednesday

» His predecessor Vinai Kumar Saxena has been appointed as the Lt Governor of Ladakh

» Preparations were underway for the oath ceremony at Lok Niwas. Saxena is scheduled to take oath as Ladakh LG on Friday, officials said

Earlier in the day, the new LG visited Lok Niwas and met Saxena, they said.

Sandhu, a 1988-batch Indian Foreign Service officer, was one of the most experienced Indian diplomats on United States affairs. He served in the Indian Mission in Washington DC multiple times.

He was India’s ambassador to the United States from February 2020 to January 2024. Previously, he served as the deputy chief of mission at the embassy in Washington from July 2013 to January 2017 and as the first secretary (political) from 1997 to 2000, with the responsibility to liaise with the US Congress.

The 63-year-old former diplomat had also been at the Permanent Mission of India to the United Nations from July 2005 to February 2009.

He unsuccessfully contested Lok Sabha polls in 2024 on the BJP ticket from Amritsar constituency in Punjab.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi High Court on Monday stayed adverse observations made by a trial court against the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) and its investigating officer in the Delhi excise policy case while hearing a revision petition filed by the agency challenging the discharge of all accused, including Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) leaders Arvind Kejriwal and Manish Sisodia.

Justice Swarana Kanta Sharma also directed the trial court to postpone proceedings in the related money laundering case under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) until the High Court decides the CBI’s plea. “I will pass an order of stay with regard to whatever remarks and statements are made against the investigating agency and officer. I will ask



the trial court to postpone the hearing of the PMLA case to a date after the hearing before this court,” the judge said while issuing notice to the accused and seeking their responses.

Appearing for the CBI, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta clarified that the agency was not seeking a stay on the discharge of the accused for now but wanted assurance that the trial court’s verdict would not affect the Enforcement Directorate’s (ED) parallel probe.

“This is one of the biggest scams in the history of the cap-

ital of this nation and in my opinion a national shame,” Mehta argued. He added that the investigation had established the alleged conspiracy and that “meticulous scientific investigation demonstrates that the money went to Goa to fund the elections for the party.”

The case stems from a 2022 FIR registered by the CBI following a complaint by Lieutenant Governor V.K. Saxena alleging that the 2021-22 Delhi excise policy was manipulated to favour certain liquor traders.

Reacting to the development, Delhi Education Minister Ashish Sood launched a sharp attack on the AAP leadership. “AAP’s claim of being ‘Kattar Imaandar’ is being exposed,” he said, adding that the High Court’s decision to stay remarks against the investigating agency shows that “the path for investigating a major

case of corruption involving public money in Delhi has now opened.”

Sood also alleged attempts to destroy evidence in the case. “If the liquor policy was correct, why were a large number of mobile phones and SIM cards destroyed?” he asked, claiming that “170 mobile phones and 43 SIM cards were destroyed to erase evidence related to the liquor policy case.” Referring to the Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) report, he said it pointed to “a potential loss of around Rs.2,202.68 crore to the government.”

He alleged government revenue fell under the new policy, claiming earnings per bottle dropped sharply while retailers’ margins rose. However, AAP leader Saurabh Bharadwaj said the trial court’s discharge order remains unchanged, calling the case “fake and fabricated.”

Focus on policy outcomes, not politics: Speaker

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Legislative Assembly Speaker Vijender Gupta on Monday urged young leaders to prioritise policy outcomes over political debate, saying the real measure of governance lies in whether laws and decisions improve the daily lives of citizens. Addressing students at Shri Ram College of Commerce (SRCC) during the 14th edition of “Minductor,” he called on the youth to combine intellectual honesty with a sense of public responsibility to help build a developed India.

Gupta, an alumnus of SRCC, returned to his alma mater as the chief guest for the event organised by the Human Resource Development Cell.



Speaking to a packed gathering of students, faculty members and aspiring policymakers, he reflected on his formative years at the institution while sharing his views on leadership, governance and the role of young minds in shaping the nation’s future. Highlighting the role of democratic institutions, the Speaker said, “The real test of governance lies beyond debate; it lies in whether our policies

actually address the concerns of ordinary citizens and improve their daily lives.” He noted that while disagreements and debate are inherent to democracy, their value ultimately depends on the effectiveness of the policies they produce.

Emphasising the role of legislatures, Gupta said assemblies and parliaments exist to examine public issues with seriousness so that meaningful and lasting solutions can be created for the common citizen.

Linking academic excellence with national progress, he remarked, “A Viksit Bharat is defined by institutions that function with integrity and laws that protect the dignity of every citizen.” He added that development should not be measured only through economic

growth, but also through strong institutions, inclusive opportunities and a culture of constructive dialogue.

Addressing students directly, Gupta encouraged them to see their professional ambitions through the lens of public service. “Your ideas must be guided by intellectual honesty and a commitment to the larger good,” he said, reminding them that the vision of Viksit Bharat 2047 depends heavily on the contributions of young economists, administrators and entrepreneurs.

Concluding his address, Gupta said that when ideas are guided by public interest and integrity, governance becomes purposeful and the goal of a developed India moves steadily closer to reality.



Civil Aviation Minister Kinjarapu Ram Mohan Naidu handed over the DGCA aerodrome licence to Noida International Airport, bringing it closer to operations. He also reviewed pending processes with the operator as the airport aims to become a major aviation and cargo hub MPOST

Delhi plans construction of PM Ekta Mall

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government is planning to set up a PM Ekta Mall in the city to promote unique products from states and Union Territories, officials said on Monday. The mall will showcase handicrafts, GI-tagged items and products under the One District, One Product (ODOP) scheme.

The Delhi Tourism and Transport Development Corporation (DTTDC) has begun hiring a consultant to prepare the architectural design, while a suitable location is being explored. Areas with existing DTTDC facilities such as Dilli Haat in INA, Majnu Ka Tila and Pitampura are under consideration.

The proposed 1,200 sq m mall may feature 36 stalls representing different states and UTs, along with cultural spaces and food courts.

42 SMART CARDS AND COUNTING

Delhi Metro superfan who rides every line on day one

NEW DELHI: From being a passenger in the inaugural Delhi Metro in 2002 to his latest ride in new corridors this year, Anil Marwah has kept the tradition of taking the first ride on new routes alive for more than two decades now.

For most people, a new metro line means a faster commute, but for the 65-year-old, it means another page in a carefully preserved album, an album not of photos but metro smart cards.

As the two new metro routes connecting Majlis Park to Maujpur and Majlis Park to Deepali Chowk were inaugurated on Sunday, the metro enthusiast was once again present with his albums, continuing his 24-year-old tradition and becoming one of the first passengers on the new corridors.

The Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) commenced train services at 3 pm on the two newly inaugurated corridors after they were flagged off earlier in the day by Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

Marwah, proudly displaying his collection, said that his album consisted of every first-day Delhi Metro smart card issued for the newly opened corridors.

His carefully preserved collection includes the cards, photographs from inaugural rides before entering the metro, newspaper clippings and even recognition from the Limca Book of World Records, all neatly stored in albums he carries to metro inaugurations.

“My story with Delhi Metro started on December 25, 2002. Earlier, I had lived in Japan for

a year from 1988 to 1989, and I was very fascinated that the metro trains there ran through the colonies. I used to wonder when something like that would start in Delhi,” Marwah stated. He recalled that when the metro finally started, he was living in Rajender Nagar and went with his son to Shahdara so that they could take the first ride.

Metro enthusiast Anil Marwah added his 42nd Delhi Metro smart card after taking the first ride on the newly opened corridors between Majlis Park-Maujpur Babarpur and Deepali Chowk-Majlis Park. Marwah, who has followed the tradition since 2002, said he hopes to continue collecting first-day cards until the 25th anniversary of the Delhi Metro. MPOST

Capital strengthens Yamuna Banks between ITO, Sarai Kale Khan to improve flood mgmt

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: To reduce flood risk in the city, the Delhi government has begun strengthening the Yamuna riverbank by stone pitching and upgrading drainage infrastructure between ITO and Sarai Kale Khan here.

The work includes reinforcing vulnerable stretches of the embankment and improving access roads along key drains and the Millennium Bund, to ensure that flood management can be carried out more effectively during heavy rainfall, officials said on Monday.

Approach roads along Drain No. 12 are being strengthened to ensure the smooth routine cleaning and emergency response during the monsoon.

Another major component of the project is also active at the ‘Millennium Bund,’



located on the right bank of the Yamuna River near Sarai Kale Khan area in South Delhi. This embankment acts as a protective barrier against the river.

The initiative is being undertaken by the Delhi Irrigation and Flood Control Department (I&FC), which is responsible for flood management and riverbank protection in the city. “This is a crucial step in strengthening the embankment and ensuring the safety of the riverbank while protecting the area from future erosion,” a

senior government official said.

According to officials, work is underway on the Millennium Bund to prevent soil erosion through the stone pitching process.

“The government hopes that strengthening embankments along the Yamuna and improving the drainage network will help mitigate flood risks and enhance the city’s preparedness for extreme weather events,” Flood control Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said. The measures will likely

improve the drainage network and reduce the risk of flooding and waterlogging in surrounding areas during the monsoon season, he added.

Stone pitching is a method in which stones are placed on the slope to prevent soil erosion. The initiative is being undertaken by the Delhi Irrigation and Flood Control Department (I&FC), which is responsible for flood management and riverbank protection in the city. Officials said the department has been working continuously to improve the effectiveness of flood-control infrastructure, particularly in areas prone to waterlogging during heavy rainfall. These drains had been causing waterlogging in their catchment areas for years, he said, adding that large-scale desilting, widening, deepening and removal of bottlenecks and encroachments had been carried out.

ACID ATTACK CASES

SC asks HCs to fix timelines for trial courts for concluding hearing

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday asked all the high courts to fix timelines for trial courts to ensure expeditious conclusion of acid attack cases in the country.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi took note of the status reports filed by several high courts on pendency and the present status of acid attack cases, and said a more proactive approach was needed.

The CJI asked the high courts to entrust the task of monitoring the trials in acid attack cases to the high court judges who are the administrative-in-charge of the trial courts.

The top court granted last opportunity to all the states to follow its directions issued from time to time on a PIL filed by Haryana-based Shaheen Malik, who herself is an acid attack survivor.



The CJI asked the states to urgently deal with the aspect of payment of adequate compensation to the victims of acid attacks.

The bench also asked Shaheen Malik about the status of her personal acid attack case.

She said the accused was acquitted by the Rohini trial court and an appeal against the acquittal was filed in the Delhi High Court.

Malik urged the CJI to ask senior advocate Siddharth Luthra to fight her legal battle in the high court.

"At the outset, we request senior advocate Siddharth

Highlights

- » The top court granted last opportunity to all the states to follow its directions issued from time to time on a PIL filed by Haryana-based Shaheen Malik
- » The CJI asked the states to urgently deal with the aspect of payment of adequate compensation to the victims of acid attacks

Luthra to represent the appellant in the Delhi High Court as pro bono free legal aid counsel," the bench ordered.

The senior advocate agreed and offered his services and assured the CJI that he will represent her in the high court.

In another case of an acid attack survivor, the top court transferred the criminal trial from a court at Bhiwani to Haryana to Saket in Delhi after taking into account the victim's serious medical condition and the difficulties she faces in participating in the proceedings.

The CJI noted that the victim suffered grave injuries in

the incident, including severe damage to one of her eyes, and is currently undergoing treatment at a private hospital here.

The bench, while directing the Haryana government to transfer the accused from a jail in Bhiwani to Tihar Central Jail in Delhi, said given the circumstances, it would be nearly impossible for the victim to effectively participate in the trial if it continued in Haryana.

While dealing with Malik's PIL, the bench on January 27 batted for "extraordinary" punitive measures for convicts in acid attack cases.

Odisha migrant worker dies in Qatar; family seeks help to bring body back

BERHAMPUR: Family members of a migrant worker from Odisha, who died in his workplace in Qatar, appealed to the government to bring his body back to his village in Ganjam district.

The Arab country has been affected by the West Asia conflict. An officer of Ganjam district said on Monday that a preliminary inquiry into his death was conducted following the request of the family, and a decision will be taken after examining the probe report.

The deceased was identified as Kuna Khuntia (25), a native of Naikanipalli in Khallikote block. The sole earning member of the family was working as a labourer in a private construction company in Doha for the last five months.

After returning from his duty on Friday night, he went to sleep and did not wake up, said a family member. AGENCIES

JOURNALIST MURDER CASE

Prosecution was unable to prove case against Ram Rahim: HC

OUR CORRESPONDENT

CHANDIGARH: The Punjab and Haryana High Court has observed that the prosecution was not able to prove its case against Dera Sacha Sauda chief Gurmeet Ram Rahim Singh in the 2002 murder of a journalist, and questioned the CBI probe.

The court on Saturday acquitted Ram Rahim Singh of the charge of involvement in the murder of journalist Ram Chander Chhatrapati.

In a 113-page judgement which came out on Monday, the court said no reliance could be placed upon a witness who "kept on tossing from one side to the other like a ping pong ball."

A division bench headed by Chief Justice Sheel Nagu acquitted the 58-year-old Dera chief more than seven years after he was convicted and sentenced to life imprisonment.

The bench, however, upheld the conviction of three others in the case.

"In the considered opinion of this court, the prosecu-



tion was not able to prove its case against A1 (Gurmeet Ram Rahim Singh) beyond reasonable doubt, whereas it was able to do so in the case of A2 to A4 (three other accused).

"It is a settled principle of law that where two possibilities, one of commission of crime and the other of innocence, are reasonably possible, the accused is entitled to the benefit of doubt," said the court.

The high court bench also expressed concern over the manner in which the CBI han-

dled the testimony of the prosecution's key witness, Khatta Singh.

The high court bench also expressed concern over the manner in which the CBI handled the testimony of the prosecution's key witness, Khatta Singh.

"In the considered opinion of this Court, absolutely no reliance can be placed on a witness like Khatta Singh. He chose to remain silent for a number of years and then kept on tossing from one side to the other like a ping pong ball," it said.

"Even on 26.12.2006, when he opened up for the first time, he did not implicate A1 in the present case and talked only about Ranjit Singh murder case. If he was under threat, it is not understood as to why he was under threat only in this case and not in Ranjit Singh case in which he stated that a conspiracy had been hatched by A1," the court said, dismissing Khatta Singh's deposition that he was under threat from Ram Rahim.

Karur stampede: CBI summons Vijay today, he seeks 15 days to appear for questioning

NEW DELHI: The CBI summoned actor and TVK chief Vijay on March 10 for a fresh round of questioning in connection with the Karur stampede case, but he sought 15 days to appear before the agency, citing political engagements, officials said on Monday.

The agency will now issue fresh summons to Vijay, they said.

According to sources, the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) had also sought the presence of Karur MLA V Senthil Balaji before the investigation team on Monday, but his staff had refused to accept the notice. The agency then emailed

him the notice seeking his presence for questioning in the case. However, it did not receive any response, the sources said.

Vijay was asked to appear before the agency here on March 10, but he sent a formal request seeking another date after 15 days, the officials said.

He also requested the agency to question him at its Chennai office or at any other office in Tamil Nadu, they said.

Highly placed sources said the agency will consider Vijay's request to be questioned in Tamil Nadu and will issue a notice with fresh dates for questioning.

The actor was earlier ques-

tioned by the agency at its headquarters here on January 12 and 19.

During the probe, the CBI has gathered material that needs further questioning and clarifications from the actor, the officials said.

The agency is yet to take a decision on the course of action regarding Balaji, they said.

The CBI took over the case from an SIT following a Supreme Court order and has been gathering evidence related to the September 27, 2025, stampede that occurred during Vijay's rally in Tamil Nadu's Karur, leaving 41 dead and over 60 injured.

In October last year, the apex court asked the CBI director to appoint a senior officer to take over the investigation and also constituted a supervisory committee headed by former Supreme Court judge Ajay Rastogi to monitor the agency's investigation.

A bench comprising Justices J K Maheshwari and N V Anjaria had said the stampede has left an imprint in the minds of citizens throughout the country. It has wide ramifications with respect to the lives of citizens, and enforcing the fundamental rights of the families who lost their kin is of utmost importance, the court said. MPOST

I-T dept detects hidden sales worth Rs 408 crore by restaurants in countrywide operation

NEW DELHI: The Income Tax Department has detected under-reporting of sales worth Rs 408 crore after it conducted a nationwide survey of restaurants on charges of tax evasion, the CBDT said on Monday.

After visiting business premises of restaurants on Sunday, the taxman is now sending emails and messages to 63,000 such outlets, "requesting" them to update their income tax returns (ITRs) by March 31, the Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT) said in a statement.

The action is part of the NUDGE -- Non-Intrusive Usage of Data to Guide and

Enable -- campaign.

"A nationwide survey was conducted on 62 restaurants across 46 cities in 22 states. On a preliminary basis, the exercise revealed suppression of sales amounting to around Rs 408 crore," the CBDT said.

The cities where the survey was undertaken include Delhi, Shimla, Murthal (Haryana), Gurugram, Guwahati, Mumbai, Chennai, Kolkata, Siliguri, Godhra, Ahmedabad, Bengaluru, Kollam, Kochi, Madurai, Coimbatore, Raipur, Bhopal, Indore, Ajmer, Jaipur, Chandigarh, Ludhiana, Koderma, Patna, Cuttack and Puri, among

others, according to I-T department officials.

The statement said that a probe into these findings is underway.

The CBDT said the investigation began after the taxman initiated a probe in November 2025 covering the food and beverage sector.

"During the exercise, it was found that several restaurants were engaged in deletion of bulk bills and other modifications to suppress the actual sales," it said.

Advanced analytics of transactional data from about 1.77 lakh restaurants was car-

ried out through AI tools. This data was compared with the turnover reported by these outlets, leading to the identification of "large-scale" under-reporting of income, the CBDT said.

In some cases, the recorded sales were not fully reflected in financial accounts or tax filings, and certain transactions were excluded from reported sales, it said.

Officials told news agency that the probe began after the department's investigation wing in Hyderabad recently surveyed the premises of a local company that creates restaurant billing software. AGENCIES

From Page 1

Iran picks

before the Israeli strike killed his 86-year-old father. His wife, Zahra Haddad Adel, was killed in the same strike.

Political figures within Iran have criticised handing over the supreme leader's title based on heredity, comparing it to the monarchy overthrown in the 1979 Islamic Revolution. But top clerics in the Assembly of Experts apparently voted for continuity.

Khamenei, who is seen as even more hard-line than his late father, will now be in charge of Iran's armed forces and any decision about Tehran's nuclear program.

Though Iran's key nuclear sites are in tatters after the US bombed them during the 12-day Israel-Iran war in June, it still has highly enriched uranium that's a technical step away from weapons-grade levels. Khamenei could choose to do what his father never did — build a nuclear bomb.

Israel has already described him as a potential target, while Trump has called him "unacceptable" and dismissed him as a "lightweight."

Both the Revolutionary Guard and the Iran-backed Lebanese militant group Hezbollah issued statements in support of Khamenei.

Top Iranian security official Ali Larijani, speaking to Iranian state television, praised the Assembly of Experts for "courageously" convening even as airstrikes pounded Tehran. He said the younger Khamenei had been trained by his father and "can handle this situation."

Regional anger has grown as energy infrastructure is hit and oil prices spike. Saudi Arabia lashed out at Iran following a thwarted drone attack on its massive Shaybah oil field, saying Tehran would be the "biggest loser" if it continues to attack Arab states.

In the United Arab Emirates, authorities said two people were wounded by shrapnel from the interception of Iranian missiles over the capital, Abu Dhabi. By mid-afternoon, the Emirati Defence Ministry said 15 ballistic missiles and 18 drones were fired

on the country on Monday, raising the total to 253 missiles and 1,440 drones launched at the UAE since the war began. So far in the war, four foreign nationals have been killed in the UAE and 117 wounded, it said.

Iran also attacked Kuwait, Qatar and Bahrain, where it hit a residential area, wounding 32 people, including several children, according to authorities. Another attack appeared to have started a fire at Bahrain's only oil refinery, sending thick plumes of smoke into the air.

The war's toll on civilian targets grew as Bahrain accused Iran of striking a desalination plant vital to drinking water supplies. Bahrain's national oil company declared force majeure for its shipments after an Iranian attack set its refinery complex ablaze. The legal declaration releases the company of contractual obligations because of extraordinary circumstances.

Oil depots in Tehran smoldered following overnight strikes by Israel.

Oil prices have surged as the war, now in its second week, ensnares countries and places that are critical to the production and movement of oil and gas from the Persian Gulf.

Roughly 15 million barrels of crude oil — about 20 per cent of the world's oil — typically are shipped every day through the Strait of Hormuz, according to independent research firm Rystad Energy. The threat of Iranian missile and drone attacks has all but stopped tankers carrying oil and gas from Saudi Arabia, Kuwait, Iraq, Qatar, Bahrain, the United Arab Emirates and Iran from traveling through the strait, which is bordered in the north by Iran.

Iraq, Kuwait and the UAE have cut oil production as storage tanks fill due to the reduced ability to export crude. Iran, Israel and the United States also have attacked oil and gas facilities since the war started, worsening supply concerns.

The surge in costs for oil and natural gas is pushing fuel prices higher, cascading through other industries and jolting Asian economies that are especially vulnerable due to the region's heavy reliance on imports from the Middle East.

Iran exports roughly 1.6 million barrels of oil a day, mostly to China, which has called for an immediate end to the fighting. Beijing may need to look else-

where for supply if Iran's exports are disrupted, another factor that could increase energy prices.

Meanwhile, another AP report from Chicago said that oil prices spiked near \$120 per barrel Monday as the Iran war intensified, threatening production and shipping in the Middle East and pummeling financial markets.

The price for a barrel of Brent crude, the international standard, surged to \$119.50 per barrel early in the day but later was trading above \$101 per barrel, up 9%. West Texas Intermediate, the light, sweet crude oil produced in the United States, also soared above \$119.48 per barrel but fell back closer to \$100.

Prices eased after French President Emmanuel Macron said the Group of Seven major industrialized powers could dip into their emergency oil stockpiles in response to soaring prices. But later Monday, the G7 said it had decided against using their strategic reserves, at least for now.

On Saturday, President Donald Trump also downplayed the idea of turning to America's Strategic Petroleum Reserve, maintaining US supplies were ample and prices would soon fall.

South Korean President Lee Jae Myung warned Monday of strict penalties for refiners and gas stations caught hoarding or colluding on prices, saying it would be wise to find alternatives to supplies that must travel through the Strait of Hormuz.

Across Southeast Asia, the spike in prices has led to long lines outside filling stations.

Meanwhile, Russian President Vladimir Putin on Monday congratulated Ayatollah Mojtaba Khamenei, the newly elected Supreme Leader of Iran, and reaffirmed Moscow's unwavering support and solidarity with Tehran, the Kremlin said.

"At a time when Iran is confronting armed aggression, your tenure in this high position will undoubtedly require great courage and dedication. I am confident that you will honourably continue your father's work and unite the Iranian people in the face of severe trials," Putin said in a message which was posted on the Kremlin's website.

"On my part, I would like to reaffirm our unwavering support for Tehran and solidarity with our Iranian friends. Russia has been and will remain a reliable partner of the Islamic Republic," Putin said.

Dalal Street

On similar lines, the 50-share NSE Nifty dropped 422.40 points, or 1.73 per cent, to end at 24,028.05. Intra-day, it tumbled 752.65 points, or 3.07 per cent, to 23,697.80.

"Selling intensified as the Middle East conflict entered its second week with no signs of de-escalation. The sustained rise in crude prices is likely to complicate the RBI's policy outlook by keeping inflation elevated and posing risks to growth. Additional concerns in the US about potential caps on redemptions in specific funds also contributed to the sell-off.

"Despite this, the current phase may offer opportunities for long-term investors. Selective value buying in pharma and IT helped limit deeper losses and indicated a defensive stance amid a weakening rupee in the short term," Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments Limited, was quoted by PTI as having said.

UltraTech Cement was the biggest loser in the Sensex pack, tumbling 5.23 per cent, followed by Maruti, Mahindra & Mahindra, State Bank of India, Inter-Globe Aviation, and Adani Ports were among the major laggards.

In contrast, Reliance Industries, Sun Pharma, Infosys, Tech Mahindra and HCL Tech were the gainers.

The rupee crashed to its all-time closing low of 92.35 (provisional) against the US dollar on Monday, losing 53 paise during the session, as global crude oil prices saw a sharp spike, and the greenback strengthened amid worsening conflict in West Asia.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth Rs 6,030.38 crore on Friday, according to exchange data.

Domestic Institutional Investors (DIIs) bought stocks worth Rs 6,971.51 crore in the previous trade.

Silver prices also declined by Rs 3,400 to Rs 2.68 lakh per kilogram, and gold traded almost flat at Rs 1,64,300 per 10 grams in Delhi on Monday as a firm US dollar dampened the precious metals' demand amid volatile global markets.

According to the All India Sarafa Association, the white metal extended its losses for the third straight day by plunging Rs 3,400, or nearly 1.3 per cent, to Rs

2,68,300 per kg (inclusive of all taxes) from Friday's closing level of Rs 2,71,700 per kg.

Meanwhile, gold of 99.9 per cent purity rose marginally by Rs 200 to Rs 1,64,300 per 10 grams (inclusive of all taxes).

The yellow metal had settled at Rs 1,64,100 per 10 grams in the previous market session, as per the Association.

Globally, spot gold fell USD 65.23, or 1.26 per cent, to trade at USD 5,105.89 per ounce, while silver was also trading 0.53 per cent lower at USD 83.92 per ounce.

Equity investors became poorer by Rs 22.40 lakh crore since the beginning of the conflict involving the US, Israel and Iran, which has rattled stock markets, driving the BSE Sensex lower by 4.6 per cent.

The market capitalisation of BSE-listed companies dropped sharply by Rs 22,40,408.82 crore to Rs 4.41,10,262.45 crore (USD 4.78 trillion) during this time.

PM

In the general elections, so far, the results for Nepal's 161 of the 165 seats have been declared under direct voting. The outcome on the remaining four seats is expected to be declared soon.

Under proportionate voting, the Rastriya Swatantra Party (RSP) has secured 4049,604 votes, followed by the NC at 13,60,281, the CPN-UML 1150,679, the NCP 591,940, the Shram Sanskriti Party 291,965, the Janata Samajwadi Party 1,16,463 and the Rastriya Parivartan Party 276,931.

With more than 40 lakh votes under the proportional representation system, the RSP is expected to secure at least 40 additional seats, taking its tally to around 164 seats in the 275-member House of Representatives, which is well above the 138 needed for a simple majority, political observers said.

EAM

walkout in the Rajya Sabha, they forced the Lok Sabha to be adjourned amid noisy scenes.

The minister said the government had issued a statement on February 28, expressing its deep concern and urging all sides to exercise restraint, avoid escala-

tion and prioritise the safety of civilians.

"We believed and continue to believe that dialogue and diplomacy should be pursued to de-escalate tensions and address underlying issues. Sir, it is also imperative that the sovereignty and territorial integrity of all states in the region be respected," he stressed.

Jaishankar said developments in the region are a cause of deep concern to "all of us", and added that the conflict has continued to intensify and the security situation in the region has deteriorated significantly.

The minister emphasised that Prime Minister Narendra Modi continues to closely monitor emerging developments and the relevant ministries are coordinating to ensure effective responses.

He said the prime minister has spoken to leaders of several countries in West Asia and has received assurances that the well-being of the Indian community would be a priority for them.

"I have similarly been in close touch with my counterparts in these countries. Insofar as the United States is concerned, we have maintained regular contacts through diplomatic channels. While attempts have been made, contacts with Iran at the leadership level are obviously difficult at this time. I have, however, spoken to Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi on February 28 and March 5, 2026. We will continue these high-level conversations in the coming days," he assured the house.

Jaishankar informed Parliament about the steps taken by the government to bring back Indians and provided details of the operation of flights by several airlines to bring back those affected.

Referring to concerns on the energy front amid rising global crude oil prices, he said the government remains committed to ensuring that fully, taking into account costs and risks of the energy markets.

"For us, the interests of the Indian consumer have and will always be the overriding priority. Where required, Indian diplomacy has supported the endeavours of our energy enterprises in this volatile situation," he asserted.

On the Iranian vessel currently docked in Kochi, the minister said the Iranian side requested permission on February 28 for three ships in the

region to dock at Indian ports and permission was accorded on March 1.

"IRIS LAVAN actually docked on 04 March in Kochi. The crew is currently in Indian naval facilities. We believe that this was the right thing to do and the Iranian Foreign Minister has expressed his country's thanks for this humane gesture," he said.

He noted that in view of the large number of Indians living and working in Gulf countries and a few thousand in Iran for study or employment, ensuring regional stability was critical for India. The Gulf is also central to India's energy security and trade, accounting for nearly USD 200 billion in commerce," he said.

The minister said attacks on merchant shipping have affected Indian seafarers, with casualties reported and one Indian mariner still missing.

He also informed Parliament that his ministry, as well as Indian embassies in West Asian countries, had been issuing regular advisories to Indian citizens there, asking them to avoid non-essential travel to Iran and advising those already there to remain in contact with the Indian embassy.

The Ministry of External Affairs has also set up a dedicated control room to monitor the situation and respond to requests from Indian nationals, while the Directorate General of Shipping has created a quick

Cheetah

of the country's reintroduction efforts.

"Good News from Kuno National Park again... Cheetah Jwala has given birth to 5 cubs, marking another major milestone for Project Cheetah," he posted on X.

The cheetah, the world's fastest land animal, became extinct in India nearly seven decades ago.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi initiated the cheetah translocation project with the release of eight big cats brought from Namibia at KNP on September 17, 2022. The ambitious project is part of India's efforts to restore the cheetah population and enhance wildlife conservation and tourism in the region.

On February 28, nine cheetahs airlifted from Botswana arrived at KNP and were released into an enclosure.

POST-BUDGET WEBINAR

Accelerate process of linking edu sector to real world economy: PM

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Monday called for accelerating the process of linking the country's education sector to the real world economy, while sharpening focus on subjects like artificial intelligence and automation.

Addressing a post-Budget webinar, he also said that fulfilling aspirations of the people is the resolve of his government and education, skill development, health, tourism, sports and culture are some of the sectors that act as a medium to fulfil them.

"Fulfilling the aspirations of the people is not just a subject, but it is the core objective and the resolution of this government," he said at the webinar which was attended by stakeholders from different government ministries, departments and experts from private



Prime Minister Narendra Modi addresses a post-Budget webinar on 'Sabka Saath Sabka Vikas-Fulfilling Aspirations of People', virtually

PTI

sectors. The Prime Minister said education, skill, health, tourism, sports, culture are fundamental sectors and major means of fulfilling these public aspirations. "In the country, continuous efforts are being made to link education with employment and enterprise. The new

National Education Policy (NEP) provides the foundation for a curriculum that must stay aligned with market demands and the real-world economy, specifically in fields like AI, automation and the digital economy. We will have to accelerate the process of linking our education system with the real world economy," he said.

PM Modi to launch NDA's Assembly poll campaign at Kochi convention

KOCHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi will inaugurate the NDA's massive election campaign convention, to be attended by around 50,000 people, here on March 11, senior BJP leaders said on Monday.

Modi will participate in the convention to be held at the Jawaharlal International Stadium in Kaloor, they said.

Addressing reporters, BJP state general secretary S Suresh said the NDA has adopted the slogan "Let change begin, Viksit Keralam with Modi" for the campaign for the upcoming Assembly polls.

He said the Prime Minister is expected to reach the international airport here by 11.30 am on Wednesday.

MPOST

Discussing the nexus between education, employment, and enterprise, the PM highlighted the promotion of the Animation, Visual Effects, Gaming and Comics (AVGC) sector.

Asserting that India is moving towards an innovation-driven economy, he called upon academic institutions to

transform their campuses into hubs of industry collaboration and research-driven learning to provide students with essential real world exposure.

"I would urge you that in this webinar, there must be a brainstorm on developing your campuses as centres of industry collaboration and research-driven learning," he said.

LS fails to take up resolution on Birla's removal as Speaker

Government unlikely to accept Opposition's demand for discussion in Parliament on West Asia conflict

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Lok Sabha on Monday could not take up a resolution seeking the removal of Speaker Om Birla amid repeated adjournments, as Opposition members demanded a debate on the West Asia situation. The government and the Chair accused the Opposition of holding the House proceedings "hostage" to its demands.

The House was adjourned for the day shortly after it reassembled at 3 pm, following an earlier adjournment due to relentless protests by Opposition members.

As proceedings resumed, Opposition MPs continued raising slogans. Jagadambika Pal, who was chairing the proceedings, urged them to maintain decorum and allow the House to take up the resolution against Birla.

Pal reminded the Opposition that the no-confidence res-



Opposition protest in Lok Sabha demanding discussion on West Asia crisis during the second part of Budget session of Parliament, in New Delhi, Monday

PTI

olution against the Speaker was already on the House agenda, and their adjournment notice seeking debate on the West Asia crisis could not be taken up.

He accused the Opposition of wasting taxpayers' money -- about Rs 9 crore per day -- by holding the House "hostage" to its demands. Pal described the Opposition behaviour as "immature and irresponsible".

He further claimed that the Opposition was working with a "political agenda" to disrupt proceedings by preventing the

House from taking up the resolution against Birla.

He said the government and the Chair were willing to take up the resolution, but the Opposition was creating obstacles, even as Birla was not presiding over the House until the no-confidence motion against him was settled.

Meanwhile, the government is unlikely to accede to the demand of the Opposition for a discussion in Parliament on the present crisis in West Asia as External Affairs minister S Jaishankar has already briefed both the Houses.

REACHES OUT TO OPPOSITION PARTIES

Trinamool Congress pushes for CEC impeachment

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Trinamool Congress (TMC) is gearing up to launch impeachment proceedings against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, marking a significant step up in its ongoing conflict with the Election Commission of India. According to party sources, the draft for the impeachment motion is in place, and the process is already

underway, with the party reaching out to other Opposition groups to garner broader support.

While specifics of the discussions are kept under wraps, this move indicates a coordinated effort by sections of the Opposition to challenge what TMC describes as a lack of transparency and accountability within the Election Commission.

The issue was also brought

up during a recent meeting of the INDIA Bloc, chaired by Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge. At the meeting, TMC's Deputy Leader in the Lok Sabha, Satadibi Roy, presented the party's concerns to the Opposition leadership and called for collective action on several issues related to electoral transparency and democratic accountability, according to a senior leader.

Mamata Banerjee-led TMC

has raised serious doubts about the integrity of the electoral process, accusing the Election Commission of functioning in a manner that raises major concerns. TMC leaders say that repeated attempts to seek clarity from Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar have yet to receive satisfactory answers. Insider sources reveal that the leadership has held three meetings with the CEC but remains dissatisfied with the explana-

tions so far.

"Enough is enough," senior party leaders declared, accusing the Chief Election Commissioner of misleading political stakeholders. The party has demanded that the Election Commission release the transcripts of earlier meetings with political representatives. Leaders warned that if the transcripts are not made public, the party might take matters into its own hands and publish them.

Air India plane crash probe report will be out 'very soon', says govt

NEW DELHI: Civil Aviation Minister K Rammoohan Naidu on Monday informed the Rajya Sabha that the AAIB probe into the fatal crash of the Air India aircraft in June last year is progressing at a very good pace, and the investigation report will be out "very soon".

Replying to a supplementary query during the Question Hour in the Rajya Sabha, Naidu said the ministry is doing its best to ensure flight operations and to bring back Indians stranded due to the West Asia conflict.

The minister, responding to various queries, told the House that the probe report into the Air India plane crash would be out soon.



Union minister Ram Mohan Naidu Kinjarapu speaks in Rajya Sabha during the second part of Budget session of Parliament, in New Delhi, Monday

PTI

Air India's Boeing 787-8 plane operating the flight AI171 enroute to London-Gatwick crashed soon after take off from Ahmedabad on June 12, 2025, killing 260 people, including 241 persons onboard,

and the crash is being probed by the Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AAIB).

"Regarding the AI171 crash that happened in June last year, the investigation is going at a very good pace, and all the resources that are required for AAIB, the primary agency which is looking into the investigation, the ministry is providing.

"And I would say that very soon, within the completion of the year, the report should be out," Naidu said.

On the West Asia situation and the safety of flight operations, Naidu said the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) immediately engaged with the airlines and issued circulars.

Defence Ministry releases ministry's new manual of security instructions

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh on Monday released a new comprehensive document outlining security guidelines to address the changing security scenario, and emphasised the need for strict adherence to security discipline amid emerging threats and evolving challenges.

He released the Manual of Security Instructions 2026 of the Ministry of Defence at a function held at the South Block here.

"The manual is a comprehensive document outlining security guidelines, which will be updated periodically to address the changing security scenario," the ministry said in a statement.

In his address, the defence secretary "emphasised the need for strict adherence to security discipline amid emerging threats and evolving security challenges".

He stressed that all officers and security personnel must "rigorously follow" the pre-scripted security procedures, the statement said.

Singh appreciated the efforts of the Security Office of the ministry in preparing these detailed security guidelines.

He urged the security personnel and officials to ensure their effective implementation, stating that the new manual would help maintain a secure environment within the ministry.

'Mid-Day Meal programme gets Rs 12,750 cr allocation for 2026-27'

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: The government has allocated Rs 12,750 crore for the Pradhan Mantri Poshan Shakti Nirman (PM POSHAN) scheme in the financial year 2026-27.

This is an increase over previous allocations. While informing Parliament on Monday, it was stated that the PM POSHAN scheme is an important rights-based centrally sponsored scheme that aims to provide hot, nutritious meals to the children in Bal Vatika and classes I to VIII in government and aided schools across the country.

In response to a query by Trinamool Congress MP Mala Roy in Parliament, Minister of State in the Education Ministry Jayant Chaudhary pointed out that nearly 11 crore children in over 10.35 lakh schools across the country were being provided with the benefits of the PM POSHAN scheme. It is the responsibility of the state governments/Union Territories to implement the scheme.

In Parliament, it has been pointed out that the budgetary allocations of the PM POSHAN scheme have been changing over the years. For the 2023-24 financial year, the budgetary allocation was Rs 11,600 crore,

but it was later reduced to Rs 10,000 crore.

However, the actual expenditure was Rs 8,457.74 crore.

In the 2024-25 financial year, the budgetary allocation was increased to Rs 12,467.39 crore, but it was later reduced to Rs 10,000 crore. However, the actual expenditure was Rs 9,902.99 crore.

In the 2025-26 financial year, the budgetary allocation was reduced from Rs 12,500 crore to Rs 10,600 crore.

However, the actual expenditure till March 3 was Rs 8,128.92 crore, as pointed out in the report submitted by the Ministry to Parliament.

Global warming accelerated significantly since 2015: Study

'Short-term natural fluctuations in global temperature caused by El Nino, volcanic eruptions and solar cycles can mask changes in long-term rate of warming'



Students cover their faces with scarves as they return after school on a sunny day, in Hyderabad, Saturday

Key Points

- » The study published in the journal Geophysical Research Letters analysed five global temperature datasets, including those managed by NASA and the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA)
- » Statistical confidence is the chance that a specific statistical method will correctly capture the true population value upon repeated sampling

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Global warming has accelerated significantly since 2015, according to a study that accounts for natural fluctuations in warming rate and influences of El Nino events, volcanic eruptions and solar cycle variation on temperature data.

Researchers, including those from Germany's Potsdam Institute for Climate Impact Research, said short-term natural fluctuations in global temperature caused by El Nino, volcanic eruptions, and solar cycles can mask changes in the long-term rate of warming.

The study published in the journal Geophysical Research

Letters analysed five global temperature datasets, including those managed by NASA and the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA).

"We filter out known natural influences in the observational data, so that the 'noise' is reduced, making the underlying long-term warming signal more clearly visible," co-author Grant Foster, a US statistics expert, said.

"The resulting adjusted and thus less 'noisy' data show that there has been acceleration with over 98 per cent confidence, with faster warming in (more than) the last 10 years than during any previous decade," the authors wrote.

Statistical confidence is the chance that a specific statistical method will correctly capture the true population value upon repeated sampling.

Subtracting the estimated influence of El Nino events, volcanic eruptions and solar variations from the datasets makes the global temperature curve less variable, which "then shows a statistically significant acceleration of global warming since about the year 2015," the team said. They also found that the years 2023 and 2024, which were exceptionally warm, become somewhat cooler, but remain the two warmest years since the beginning of instrumental records.

S. E. RAILWAY - TENDER
e-Tender Notice No. DCE-CON-BKSC-01-2026, dated 06.03.2026. e-Tender is invited by Dy. Chief Engineer (CON)/I, Garden Reach, Kolkata-700043, S.E. Railway for and on behalf of the President of India for the following work. Following tender has been uploaded on website www.ireps.gov.in The tender will be closed at 12.00 hrs. on due date. Brief Description of Works: Providing and laying of 900mm dia MS Casing pipe to accommodate 600mm dia MS carrier pipe line at a depth of minimum 3.0m below running Railway track by Horizontal drilling method along with the work of de-aunching of existing overhead pipeline with structure at Bhujudih yard in lieu of existing overhead water supply pipe line crossing between Km. 313/27-28 at Bhujudih Yard of Adra division under Dy. Chief Engineer/ Con/Bokaro Steel City of S. E. Railway. Approx. Cost: ₹ 4.60 Cr. Bid Security: ₹ 3,80,100/-. Completion period: 04 months. Closing Date: 01.04.2026. Interested tenderers may visit website www.ireps.gov.in for full details/description/specification of the tenders and submit their bids online. In no case manual tenders for these items will be accepted. N.B.: "Prospective Bidders may regularly visit www.ireps.gov.in to participate in all other tenders." (PR-1277)

millenniumpost CLASSIFIEDS
CHANGE OF NAME
I, Shiv Prasad Jaiswal S/o, Late Sh. Doodh Nath Jaiswal R/o D-87 Second Floor, Mansarover Garden, New Delhi-110015, do hereby declare that name of my mine and my father have been wrongly written as Shiva Prasad and Doodha Nath in my educational certificates. That the actual name of mine and my father is Shiv Prasad Jaiswal and Doodh Nath Jaiswal respectively which may be amended accordingly.

PUBLIC NOTICE
I, Neeta Rana, W/o Ajay Singh, D/o Shri Ajab Singh Rana and Smt. Anandi Devi, R/o RZ-L-13, L Block, Mahavir Enclave (Nanda Block), Palam Village, South West Delhi - 110045, have changed my name to Neeta Mahar after my marriage with Ajay Singh on 14 April 1999 at Dangchora, Siloli, Tehri Garhwal, Uttarakhand and henceforth I shall be known as Neeta Mahar for all purposes. I further declare that my date of birth earlier recorded as 03/08/1980 is incorrect and my correct date of birth is 14/05/1977. Neeta Mahar (Formerly Neeta Rana)

सेंट्रल बैंक ऑफ इंडिया Central Bank of India
1911 से आपके लिए "केन्द्रित" "CENTRAL" TO YOU SINCE 1911
MADIPUR BRANCH, B5/147, PASCHIM VIHAR, NEW DELHI-110063
PUBLIC NOTICE
This is to inform all parties that the Central Bank of India, Branch- Madipur is considering granting a loan for purchase of the property - Flat No. G-706, 7th Floor, Block-G, Som Vihar Apartment, R.K.Puram, Sector 10, New Delhi 110022 Along with scooter Garage No. S-10. Super Area 1484 sq.ft. Owned by 1. Lt. Col. R.S.Kadyan (deceased) 2. Anjana Kadyan (Deceased). Being sold by legal heirs 1.Renu Patel and 2. Rajbir Singh Kadyan. Any person having by objection Please contact the branch manager within 7 days (8800013522) Sd/- (Branch Head), Central Bank of India, Madipur Branch, New Delhi

OFFICE OF THE MUNICIPAL CORPORATION BHOPAL
Water Work Department
Municipal Corporation Rest House, Shyamla Hills, Bhopal
Ph No 0755-2701669
NOTICE INVITING e-TENDER
Online tenders are being invited for the following works. The bidder can obtained detailed information and tender documents on website http://mptenders.gov.in. Corrigendum for this NIT shall not be issued separately in newspapers. Corrigendum regarding correction can be seen on the website http://mptenders.gov.in

Sr. No.	NIT No.	Tender Id	Details of Work	Estimated Cost (INR)	Earnest Money (EMD)	Bid Submission End Date
1	11/T.Sec./EE./W.W.D./2025-26 Second call	2026- UAD_479568_2	Providing Laying and Jointing of Pipeline for providing bulk connection to J.K. Hospital under Zone 18 Ward 82.	1,24,61,164/-	62,305.00	23.03 2026

Sd/-
Executive Engineer(WWD)
Municipal Corporation, Bhopal
T.N.3279/025/026

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
Tender Notice No. : DY.CPM-GSU-PRYJ-11-2026 Dated : 06.03.2026
E-Tender Notice
Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering)/North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites the following E-Tender on prescribed form for the following works up to 15:00 hrs. On 30.03.2026 The details of the tenders are as under:
Tender No. : GSU-11 Approx. Cost of Work (Rs.) : Rs. 188541994.78
Name of work : Provision of 04 Nos. Island Platforms and Station Building at GMC Kanpur in view of development of GMC as a satellite station.
Earnest money (Rs.) : Rs. 1092700.00 Completion Period : 12 Months
Date of Opening of tender : 30.03.2026 15:00
Similar work for Eligibility Criteria : Any civil engineering work.
Note : (1) Tender on line can be submitted up to 15:00 hrs on 30.03.2026 (2) The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders are available on Website www.ireps.gov.in up to 15:00 hrs, on the due date of tender opening i.e. 30.03.2026 515/26 (AS)
North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

UJVN LIMITED
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com
Letter No: 201 Date: 08/03/2026
NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Office of the Executive Engineer PCM Dhalipur, Dehradun invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of the tender is given below:
Tender No-41/EE/PCM/Dhalipur/2025-26
Name of work- Repair of lining of Power Channel on D/S Dhakrani Power House to Skew bridge.
Estimated value of Tender: Rs. 24,95,582.00 (GST Extra)
Date & Time of availability of bid document on website: 09.03.2026 at 17:00 Hrs
Last Date & Time for submission of tender: 30.03.2026 up to 15:00 Hrs
For fuller and further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "https://ujvnli.uk.gov.in".
Executive Engineer
"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE
(Through e-tendering)
Tender No. 558-Sig-16-Tele-OT-1030 Dated: 09.03.2026
Name of work with its location: Provision of Telecom facilities in c/w 1. Improvement of Conference hall of Engineering Department (Annexe-I) at Baroda house (E.No.118/24-25/WE) 2. Improvement of General Admn. Section of 'G' Branch, GM's Conference Hall at Main Building. Committee Room at Ground Floor & First Floor of Annexe-I at Baroda House (IE.No.134/24-25/WE) 3. Improvement of Room Nos. 439 and 440A of the Engineering Branch at Annexe-I in Baroda House (133/24-25/WE) 4. Improvement of hall, Rooms of Store department in Annexe-I building at Baroda House (119/24-25/WE) 5. Improvement to damaged flooring, walls, ceiling of corridors, rooms, halls, staircase of Accounts Building (Annexe-II) at Baroda House (108/24-25/WE).
App. Cost of the work (₹) ₹ 2,23,40,863.58/- only
Earnest Money Deposit (₹) ₹ 2,61,700/- only
Address of the office: Senior Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer-C, Northern Railway, 3rd Floor, Annexe-1, DRM office, New Delhi-110055.
Date & Time for upload the tender / closing of tender: Tender uploading/closing date & time- 01.04.2026 up to 15.00 hrs.
Website particular & notice board location where complete details of the tender can be seen etc. See the Northern Railway website www.ireps.gov.in & Notice board at S&T branch, 3rd Floor, DRM office, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055
781/26
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASTRA
Public Works Division, Dharashiv
E-Tender Notice No. :— 19/2025-26
Second Call
Online Tenders Tenders are invited by the Executive Engineer, Public Works Division, Dharashiv (Phone No. 02472-222882183) in B-1 from eligible contractors.
Website https://mahaetnders.gov.in & https://pwd.maharashtra.gov.in
Sd/-
(S J Keri)
Executive Engineer
DGIPR/2026/26/6439 Public Works Division Dharashiv

AIRSPACE CURB WOES

IndiGo's Manchester flight returns to Delhi, London-Mumbai diverted to Cairo

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: A Manchester-bound IndiGo flight, operated with a leased Boeing 787 aircraft, returned to the national capital on Monday due to certain restrictions when the plane was to enter the Eritrea airspace, according to sources.

Also, an IndiGo flight from London Heathrow to Mumbai was diverted to Cairo following issues related to entering Eritrea airspace, they added.

The flight to Manchester was airborne for more than six hours before it decided to turn back. By the time it landed in the national capital, the flight had been in the air for over 12 hours. It had taken off from Delhi at around 12.40 am and landed back in the national capital at about 2.30 pm on Monday, as per information available with flight tracking website Flightradar24.com.

“Our flight 6E 033 operating from Delhi to Manchester had to return to its origin due to last-minute airspace restrictions, owing to the ongoing situation in West Asia. We are working with the relevant authorities to explore the possibilities of resuming the journey,” IndiGo said in a statement.

The sources said that there were some approval issues with Eritrean authorities, and after a risk assessment, it was decided that the flight would return to Delhi.

Eritrea is an African country.

Meanwhile, flight 6E2 from London Heathrow to Mumbai was diverted to Cairo (Egypt) due to the approval issues with the Eritrean authorities, the

Liquor worth over Rs 42 cr seized along Guj borders in 2 years: Govt

AHMEDABAD: Liquor worth more than Rs 42 crore was seized from checkpoints along Gujarat's borders with Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan in the past two years, the state government informed the assembly on Monday.

Gujarat is a dry state where prohibition is in force.

Replying to a question by Congress MLA Imran Khedawala, Gujarat Deputy Chief Minister Harsh Sanghavi, who handles the Home portfolio, said 10,49,855 bottles of Indian Made Foreign Liquor (IMFL) worth Rs 38.89 crore and 1,59,265 bottles of beer worth Rs 3.33 crore were seized in a two-year period ending January 25.

The seizures were made at checkpoints located along the borders with Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan, which are often used for smuggling liquor into Gujarat, Sanghavi said in his written reply, adding that 1,018 accused persons have been arrested so far and 141 are absconding.

Replying to a question raised by AAP MLA Gopal Italia, Sanghavi said more than 32,000 of cases have been registered against people found consuming liquor without permit in Ahmedabad and Vadodara districts over the past two years.

According to the data shared in the Assembly, 17,311 cases were registered against persons found consuming liquor without permit in Ahmedabad district, while 15,154 such cases were recorded in Vadodara district as of December 31, 2025.

The minister said the police have also taken various preventive measures against those supplying liquor to such consumers. These include increased patrolling in areas where people are repeatedly found consuming liquor, as well as prohibition drives conducted at the city, district and state levels.

Sanghavi said individuals frequently involved in illegal liquor activities are declared as “listed bootleggers”, after which periodic raids are carried out against them.

MPOST



REPRESENTATIVE PIC

HIGHLIGHTS

» The flight to Manchester was airborne for more than six hours before it decided to turn back

» By the time it landed in the national capital, the flight had been in the air for over 12 hours

» The other flight was airborne for more than eight hours before landing at Cairo

sources said.

The flight, operated with a leased Boeing 787 plane, was airborne for nearly six hours before the decision was taken to divert to Cairo.

Overall, the flight was airborne for more than eight hours before landing at Cairo, as per information from Flight-radar24.com.

One of the sources said the airline would not be operating the flight from Cairo to Mumbai on Monday as the crew had exhausted flight duty time. The

airline is working to arrange visas and hotel accommodation for passengers, and the flight is expected to fly to Mumbai on Tuesday, the source added.

There was no immediate statement from the airline on the 6E2 flight.

IndiGo is operating its flights to European cities and London, except for Athens, with Boeing 787-9 planes leased from Norway's Norse Atlantic Airways.

In the wake of the Middle East conflict, regulator EASA (European Union Aviation Safety Agency) has barred aircraft, including those of Norse Atlantic, registered with it from using certain airspaces in the Middle East, including Saudi Arabia.

As a result, IndiGo is now taking the longer flight route through Africa to enter Europe. For the European flights, the airline flies over the Arabian Sea, Ethiopia, Eritrea, the Red Sea and Egypt before entering Europe.

Meanwhile, the flights to Athens are operated with IndiGo's A321 XLR planes.

Generally, Indian carriers use the airspaces in the Middle East, including Saudi Arabia, to operate flights to Europe.

IndiGo, in the statement, also said that due to the evolving situation in and around the Middle East, some of its flights may take longer routes or experience diversions.

UP Prerna Canteen initiative: Over 10,000 women become ‘Lakhpatis’

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: More than 10,000 women in Uttar Pradesh have reportedly become lakhpatis after joining the state government's Prerna Canteen initiative aimed at promoting economic empowerment among rural women.

The scheme, launched under the guidance of Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, has expanded rapidly across the state with more than 2,100 Prerna Canteens currently operational. These canteens are largely run by women associated with self-help groups and are emerging as a strong source of income and employment in rural areas.

Officials said the initiative is helping women move towards financial independence by providing them with regu-

“These canteens, largely run by women associated with SHGs, are emerging as a strong source of income and employment in rural areas”

lar earning opportunities. By linking self-help groups with government institutions, the programme is creating a sustainable model for women-led micro enterprises.

The canteens are being operated at District Magistrate offices, Chief Development Officer offices, Block offices, and at health facilities, including Primary Health Cen-

tres and Community Health Centres. They serve affordable and hygienic meals to government employees, patients and visitors.

As part of a special drive initiated by the state government, Prerna Canteens have also been set up at several health centres. According to officials, 832 canteens are currently functioning at PHCs and CHCs across the state.

The initiative has created a steady source of income for thousands of rural women. On average, each woman associated with a Prerna Canteen earns more than Rs 10,000 per month.

Officials said the additional income has helped improve household financial stability while also encouraging more women to participate in economic activities.

One in seven Indians affected by mental health disorders: Experts

‘Urgent need to strengthen institutional capacity amid emerging healthcare demands’

KEY POINTS

» At a post-budget webinar breakout session, experts deliberated on the Union Budget announcements, which focus on strengthening mental health infrastructure by establishing NIMHANS-2 and upgrading key institutions.

» The Union Budget announced the establishment of a second National Institute of Mental Health and Neuro



REPRESENTATIVE PIC

Sciences in North India to improve regional access to mental healthcare

over 60 per cent of deaths in the country, with neurological and mental health conditions being among the leading contributors to disability-adjusted life years (DALYs).

In this context, strengthening tertiary mental health institutions and expanding specialised services were identified as critical priorities for the healthcare system, a health ministry statement said.

The session also noted that North India currently lacks adequate tertiary neuro-psychiatric care facilities, particularly in areas such as advanced neuroimaging, neurocritical care,

and specialised neurological services.

They observed that the establishment of NIMHANS-2, along with the modernisation of existing mental health institutions, would enhance advanced clinical care, training capacity, research capability, and innovation in neurosciences, it said.

Participants also proposed the creation of a National Brain-Mind Cloud Network under the National Health Mission, which would connect premier institutions such as All India Institute of Medical Sciences, state medical colleges, and primary health-

care centres.

The proposed network could facilitate unified mental health records, AI-based screening tools, data-driven decision support systems, and tele-neuro-psychiatric hubs at regional centres, enabling coordinated care delivery.

Emphasising the need for a multipronged and integrated approach to strengthen mental healthcare delivery, the experts drew special attention to improving services in underserved and geographically remote regions, including the northeastern states, the statement said.

AGENCIES

GOVT COMING UP WITH NEW BILL

SC allows Centre to extend tenure of tribunal members facing retirement

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday approved a proposal of the Centre extending the term of chairpersons and members of various tribunals in the country and are due to retire soon, till September 8.

A bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Joymalya Bagchi approved the proposal after Attorney General R Venkataramani said that the Union government was mulling bringing in a new tribunal Bill related to their functioning and appointments of their members either in the ongoing Budget session or the Monsoon session of Parliament.

He submitted that currently, deliberations are going on at various levels of the government. To avoid any confusion or problem in the functioning of tribunals,



FILE PIC

it has been decided to give an extension of tenure to all members who are set to retire in the interregnum till September 8 of this year.

“The Government is working on a proposal. A Bill is being contemplated. We don't want any interruption in the meantime.”

“Everybody who was appointed under the Tribunal Reforms Act of 2021 will continue. By next September, either this Budget session or the Mon-

Businessman killed in BMW crash in Alwar

JAIPUR: A Jaipur-based businessman died after his BMW car overturned following a collision on an expressway in Rajasthan's Alwar district on Sunday evening, police said.

Vallabh Maheshwari (62), managing director of Shakun Group, was travelling from Jaipur to Mathura when the accident occurred on the expressway under the Raini police station area.

According to the police, the driver lost control of the car, and it broke through roadside barricades and crashed into the median before hitting the wall of a culvert. The vehicle was severely damaged in the accident.

Maheshwari and his driver were taken to a local hospital. After primary treatment,

Vallabh Maheshwari (62), managing director of Shakun Group, was travelling from Jaipur to Mathura when the accident occurred on the expressway

Maheshwari was referred to another hospital in Alwar, where doctors declared him dead. The driver received mild injuries.

Former Rajasthan chief minister Ashok Gehlot, Leader of Opposition Tilaram Jolly expressed grief over Maheshwari's death.

MPOST

Haryana CM transfers ₹1,884 crore to beneficiaries of various schemes

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Monday transferred around Rs 1,884 crore to beneficiaries across the state through Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) under various welfare schemes.

Saini said the transfer reflects the state government's commitment to strengthening welfare delivery. He added that under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the “double-engine” government in Haryana is taking continuous steps to empower farmers, women, youth and economically weaker sections.

The Chief Minister said that during the state-level function held in Sirsa on Sunday to mark International Women's Day, an amount of Rs 1,357 crore related to various women-centric



FILE PIC

schemes was transferred to beneficiaries' bank accounts through DBT. Monday's transfer of Rs 1,884 crore was an additional disbursement under multiple schemes, he added.

Under the Social Security Pension Schemes of the Social Justice, Empowerment, Welfare of Scheduled Castes and Backward Classes and Antyodaya (SEWA) Department, Rs 842.92 crore was directly transferred into the bank accounts of 26.12 lakh beneficiaries. The amount covers pensions such as Old Age Allowance, Disability Allowance and other social security benefits.

Saini also said insurance claims for Kharif-2025 crops under the Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana have been released to farmers. A total of Rs 711.69 crore was credited to the bank accounts of 1,67,460 farmers on Monday.

He said that over the past 11 years, farmers in the state have received about Rs 16,160 crore as crop compensation and insurance claims under the scheme. In comparison, only Rs 1,138 crore was released during the previous Congress government's 10-year tenure, he claimed.

Saini added that the BJP government had also cleared Rs 269 crore in pending farmers' compensation after coming to power in Haryana in 2014. Additional commission payable to arthiyas (commission agents) was also transferred to beneficiaries' accounts on Monday, he said.

MP HC voids Cong MLA's bypoll win, declares BJP's Rawat elected

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA

BHOPAL: The Gwalior Bench of the Madhya Pradesh High Court on Monday set aside the 2024 by-election victory of Congress legislator Mukesh Malhotra from Vijaypur Assembly constituency in Sheopur district, holding that he had concealed information about pending criminal cases in his election affidavit.

Allowing a petition filed by the losing candidate, the single bench of Justice G S Ahluwalia declared Malhotra's election “null and void” and pronounced BJP leader Ramniwas Rawat as the duly elected MLA from the constituency.

The bypoll, held in November 2024, had witnessed a political contest between two turncoats. Malhotra, a former BJP leader who had joined the Congress, contested on the Congress ticket, while Rawat, a five-time Congress MLA who switched to the BJP ahead of the 2024 Lok Sabha elections, fought the election as the BJP candidate.

In the by-election, Malhotra secured around 1,00,469 votes and defeated Rawat by a margin of about 7,364 votes. Rawat, who polled nearly 93,105 votes, finished in second place. After joining the BJP, Rawat had also been inducted as a minister in the Mohan Yadav-led Madhya Pradesh government and was given charge of the Forest portfolio. However, he later resigned from the ministerial post due to losing the by-election.

Challenging the victory of Malhotra, Rawat approached the High Court alleging that Malhotra had failed to fully disclose details of criminal cases pending against him in his election affidavit.

Counsel for the petitioner, MPS Raghuvan-



shi, said that the Supreme Court has repeatedly emphasised that candidates contesting elections must file affidavits along with their nomination papers disclosing complete details of criminal antecedents. According to him, the information furnished by Malhotra regarding four criminal cases was incomplete, and details of some other cases were allegedly not disclosed at all.

Accepting the contention, the High Court held that the suppression of material information relating to criminal cases amounted to a corrupt practice and warranted setting aside the election result. The court consequently cancelled Malhotra's victory and declared Rawat, who had secured the second-highest number of votes in the by-election, as the elected representative from Vijaypur.

The court has given Malhotra one week to challenge the order before a higher court.

The Vijaypur bypoll had been necessitated after Rawat resigned as the five-time sitting Congress MLA from the seat in July 2024 before joining the BJP.

Mideast: CBSE postpones Class 12 board exams till March 16

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) on Monday postponed the Class 12 board exams till March 16 in the Middle East amid the Iran-Israel conflict, officials said.

The fresh dates were not immediately announced.

“After a critical review of the current situation in parts of the Middle East -- Bahrain, Iran, Kuwait, Oman, Qatar, Saudi Arabia and the UAE -- mental agony of the students and the prevailing uncertainties, the board has decided to postpone (class) 12 exams scheduled from March 12 to 16,” said CBSE Examination Controller Sanyam Bhardwaj.

The new dates will be announced later, and for further exams, the situation will be reviewed on March 14, he said.

mp
EDITORIAL
CONTINUITY OF
RESISTANCE?

The elevation of Mojtaba Khamenei as Iran's new Supreme Leader, days after the assassination of Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, reveals far more than a succession decision. It reflects the Islamic Republic's strategic mindset in the middle of a high-stakes conflict with the United States and Israel. Leadership transitions in Iran have always been carefully choreographed moments, but this one unfolded under extraordinary circumstances. The killing of the country's most powerful figure during wartime could have triggered instability or a pause for internal deliberation. Instead, Tehran moved quickly to install a successor closely tied to the existing power structure. The message is unmistakable: Iran intends to preserve continuity, project resilience and signal that the war will not alter the ideological foundations of the state.

Mojtaba Khamenei's rise is significant because he embodies the intersection of clerical authority and security power that has defined Iran's political system since the revolution of 1979. Unlike traditional religious leaders who ascend primarily through theological standing, Mojtaba's influence has long been rooted in his relationships with the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC), the powerful military and political institution that sits at the heart of Iran's security apparatus. His connections with the IRGC date back to the Iran-Iraq war era, when many of the officers who now dominate the organisation forged lasting networks within the revolutionary establishment. Over time, Mojtaba developed influence within the clerical hierarchy, the security services and the political machinery surrounding the Supreme Leader's office. In the current wartime climate, such links matter far more than formal clerical rank.

The choice of Mojtaba, therefore, suggests that Tehran is doubling down on the security establishment that is prosecuting the conflict. The IRGC has been central to Iran's military strategy, overseeing missile capabilities, regional proxy networks and asymmetric warfare operations across West Asia. Installing a leader closely aligned with this institution strengthens the hardline faction within the Iranian state at a moment when the regime believes it faces an existential threat. In calmer circumstances, the leadership succession might have produced a compromise candidate capable of easing internal tensions or engaging more pragmatically with international actors. War, however, changes the calculus. When survival becomes the overriding concern, regimes often prefer continuity and loyalty over experimentation.

The symbolism surrounding Mojtaba's appointment also carries political weight inside Iran. The Islamic Republic was founded partly in opposition to hereditary rule, yet the elevation of the son of the previous Supreme Leader inevitably raises questions about dynastic succession. For critics within Iran, the move could reinforce long-standing concerns about the concentration of power within a narrow elite. But the regime appears willing to absorb that criticism in exchange for stability at the top. The assassination of Ayatollah Khamenei has already been framed domestically through the language of martyrdom, a powerful theme in Shia political culture. By presenting the succession as a continuation of sacrifice and resistance, the leadership can mobilise national sentiment and reinforce the narrative that Iran is engaged in a historic struggle against external forces.

Ultimately, Mojtaba Khamenei's rise indicates that Iran is preparing for a prolonged confrontation rather than a negotiated pause. The country's leadership believes that external pressure is aimed not merely at weakening its military capabilities but at forcing regime change. Under such circumstances, the priority becomes cohesion within the ruling system and alignment between political authority and military power. Mojtaba represents precisely that alignment. Whether this consolidation strengthens Iran's strategic position or deepens its isolation remains uncertain. What is clear, however, is that the succession signals a regime that intends to fight, endure and define the conflict on its own ideological terms rather than seek quick accommodation with its adversaries.

FINANCIAL
VEILS



SHANTONU SEN
THE WRITER IS A
FORMER JOINT
DIRECTOR
OF THE CBI

Sophisticated financial crime often survives not because investigators fail, but because evidence struggles to match the law's demanding standards

When Crime Wears a Suit

A little-known early-1990s investigation into Musaliyar & Sons Enterprises reveals how organised networks channel illicit money through seemingly legitimate commercial structures

Corruption rarely appears in public life wearing the crude mask of illegality. More often, it arrives clothed in paperwork, procedure, and plausible explanations. It is this quieter and more insidious form of corruption that I had the opportunity to witness during my years at the Central Bureau of Investigation.

The story revolves around an obscure entity named Musaliyar & Sons Enterprises, known as MSE, which existed on paper as a modest travel-related business in Bombay during the early 1990s. In reality, according to investigators, it functioned as something far more troubling. It was believed to be a conduit for laundering the illicit wealth of the underworld empire of Dawood Ibrahim. The allegation was stark. Proceeds from extortion rackets, narcotics trade, contract killings, and illegal construction were allegedly routed through layers of seemingly legitimate commercial activity.

At the centre of this arrangement stood East West Travel & Trade Links, an airline ticketing agency that had grown at an astonishing pace. Starting modestly in 1982 with a small staff and a turnover of merely Rs. 30 lakhs, the organisation expanded within a decade into a sprawling operation with thousands of employees, dozens of destinations, and an enormous financial footprint. Investigators believed that this meteoric growth concealed a darker financial architecture. MSE operated as a sub-agent within this network, selling airline tickets and channelling cash flows that were suspected to be far



Corruption rarely arrives wearing illegality openly. It often travels through paperwork, procedure and plausible explanations

larger than any legitimate business activity could justify.

Between 1991 and 1993, tax authorities alleged that nearly Rs 9 crores had been laundered through MSE. The company itself was a curious structure. It had virtually no infrastructure. There were no salaried employees, no bank accounts, no telephone expenses, no office maintenance costs, and barely any trace of the normal operational footprint of a business that claimed to handle transactions running into crores of rupees. Yet records showed large volumes of ticketing transactions and cash movement attributed to it.

The partners of MSE offered a simple explanation. They claimed that the money represented proceeds from ticket sales conducted on behalf of East West Travel & Trade Links and its network of agents. According to them, these transactions merely passed through MSE before being distributed to the relevant parties. The cash, they

argued, was therefore not unexplained income but part of a legitimate commercial arrangement.

The tax authorities were unconvinced. Assessing officers who examined the case concluded that the entire structure appeared artificial. Their orders pointed to the absence of employees, the lack of infrastructure, the non-existence of operational expenses, and the implausibility of partners themselves performing routine clerical functions such as issuing tickets, collecting cash, and maintaining accounts for transactions worth crores of rupees. Statements from passengers who had travelled on the airlines further complicated the narrative. Several denied having purchased tickets from MSE despite records suggesting otherwise.

To investigators, these inconsistencies formed part of a larger pattern. The suspicion was that MSE existed primarily as a financial conduit, a paper entity designed to give a veneer of legitimacy to large

volumes of unexplained cash. The investigation suggested that the cash could well have originated from criminal activities controlled by Dawood Ibrahim's network and that the travel agency structure provided a convenient mechanism for layering and integration of illicit funds.

However, the matter took an unexpected turn in the appellate process. The Income Tax Appellate Tribunal overturned the findings of the tax authorities. In doing so, it accepted the explanation advanced by MSE that the cash flows represented proceeds of ticket sales through East West Travel & Trade Links and its sub-agents. The tribunal concluded that the source of the money stood explained and that the additions made by the assessing officers as unexplained income could not be sustained.

For investigators who had spent years tracing financial trails and assembling evidence, the decision came as a profound disappointment. The tribunal's reasoning appeared to rest heavily on the formal structure of transactions rather than the surrounding circumstances that had raised suspicion in the first place. The complex web that investigators believed pointed to laundering of underworld funds was reduced, in the eyes of the appellate forum, to a set of commercial entries whose legitimacy could not be conclusively disproved.

This episode illustrates a recurring dilemma in the fight against corruption and organised crime. Criminal enterprises rarely operate through crude or easily identifiable mechanisms. Instead, they rely

on layers of intermediaries, shell entities, and seemingly legitimate commercial transactions. Each layer adds distance between the original crime and the eventual financial record, making it difficult to establish a direct evidentiary chain.

Law enforcement agencies often confront this challenge with painstaking investigations, but the legal system demands proof that meets strict evidentiary standards. When criminal ingenuity meets procedural rigour, the result can sometimes be an uncomfortable gap between suspicion and proof. It is within this gap that sophisticated corruption and financial crime frequently survive.

The story of Musaliyar & Sons Enterprises is therefore not merely about a single tax dispute or investigative setback. It is a reminder of how corruption adapts itself to the structures of legality. When illicit money travels through the channels of legitimate commerce, it acquires a disguise that can be remarkably difficult to pierce.

In the end, the failure of that case was not simply the failure of an investigation. It reflected a broader reality about corruption in complex financial systems. The law may possess a long arm, but those who manipulate power and money often learn how to operate just beyond its reach.

That uncomfortable truth remains one of the enduring lessons of this episode. Or is it that the higher judiciary looks for manna, and investigators do not satisfy them, or is judicial corruption the culprit?

Views expressed are personal

GREY ZONE



OP SINGH &
HIMANSHU DIXIT

OP SINGH IS A
FORMER DGP OF
UTTAR PRADESH
AND PRESIDENT
OF INDIAN POLICE
FOUNDATION;
HIMANSHU DIXIT IS
A LAWYER AT DELHI
HIGH COURT

The Sabnam Khatun ruling highlights the urgent need for balanced regulation that protects legitimate spa businesses while addressing exploitation and trafficking concerns

Healing Hands or Hidden Hazards?

India's fast-growing spa and wellness industry operates in a regulatory grey zone, exposing legitimate businesses to legal uncertainty and moral policing

Due to growing health awareness in urban Indian society, spas and massage centres have rapidly increased across cities. As a blend of alternative therapy and modern wellness, these establishments operate within a complicated socio-legal environment that often produces serious challenges. Despite their legitimate role in health and relaxation, the industry faces persistent legal and social scrutiny. Therapists, women workers and business owners have frequently encountered moral policing, random raids and unclear regulatory frameworks. Such actions often compromise their constitutional right to practise trade and business under Article 19(1)(g) of the Constitution of India.

The judgment of the Punjab and Haryana High Court in *Sabnam Khatun v. State of Punjab* (2025) represents an important step toward regulating spas, massage centres and beauty parlours. The decision highlights the need for balanced reforms that recognise legitimate business interests while addressing social concerns and legal obligations.

The Urban Indian Wellness Boom
India's growing interest in health and wellness has contributed significantly to the expansion of spas and massage centres in urban areas. These establishments are commonly located in high-end neighbourhoods, tourist destinations, beach towns and pilgrimage centres. Many operate independently while others function as branches of salons or beauty parlours.

Massage therapy itself has a long history dating back to ancient Chinese traditions around 3000 BC. Over centuries, it has evolved into a professional wellness service supported by modern research. Studies conducted by the Touch Research Institute indicate that massage therapy can reduce stress, improve blood circulation, relieve muscle tension and enhance emotional well-being through the release of serotonin and endorphins. It has also found applications in sports medicine, rehabilitation and treatment of certain medical conditions such as depression and low body weight among premature infants.

In today's fast-paced urban life, where stress-related disorders are increasingly common, such wellness centres can play an important role in promoting both physical and mental health. However, the industry continues to face serious socio-legal challenges that undermine its credibility and growth.

Ambiguity in the Regulatory Environment
The spa and massage industry operates at the intersection of con-



Legitimate wellness businesses often operate under suspicion because the law still struggles to distinguish therapy from exploitation

stitutional protections, municipal regulations and criminal laws. Article 19 of the Constitution guarantees citizens the right to practise any profession or carry on any trade or business. Yet this right is subject to reasonable restrictions in the interests of morality, public order and regulation.

Civic Regulations
Under the Constitution's Seventh Schedule, state governments have the authority to legislate on matters related to public order, public health, sanitation, policing and regulation of businesses. This power allows states to create regulatory frameworks governing spas and massage establishments. However, in practice, regulation varies widely across jurisdictions.

Some cities have adopted relatively structured systems. For instance, in Chennai, spa and massage centres must obtain trade licences from civic authorities along with No Objection Certificates from police and health departments. Municipal rules require maintenance of registers, installation of CCTV cameras, reasonable fee structures and strict prohibition of prostitution-related services. These provisions provide clarity while protecting public interests.

Similarly, the Government of Delhi introduced Spa and Massage Rules in 2021. These rules attempt to regulate licensing, operations and compliance standards, although certain provisions are currently being challenged before the High Court.

In contrast, most Indian states lack dedicated legislation governing the spa and massage sector. States such as Uttar Pradesh largely rely on general municipal laws like the Uttar Pradesh Municipalities Act, 1916, the Municipal Corporation Act, 1959 and state-level shops and establishments laws. These laws regulate businesses broadly but do not specifically address the unique

nature of spas and massage centres. Many municipal laws merely classify certain trades as "offensive" or focus on preventing immoral activities such as solicitation and operation of brothels.

This regulatory gap has allowed spas and massage centres to proliferate without a uniform framework governing their activities. At the same time, the absence of clear rules has resulted in overlapping jurisdictions between municipal bodies, police authorities and local administrations.

Criminal Laws and Moral Policing
The lack of clear regulations often leads to spas being viewed with suspicion by law enforcement agencies and sections of society. While legitimate wellness services are lawful, they are frequently conflated with illegal activities such as trafficking or prostitution.

Police intervention usually occurs under the broader mandate of maintaining public order. According to Crime in India statistics, more than 1,400 cases are registered annually under the Immoral Traffic (Prevention) Act, 1956. Additionally, around 1,300 cases related to human trafficking or exploitation are reported each year under criminal laws.

Human trafficking and forced exploitation are serious crimes that require strict enforcement. Police often act on complaints from residents who suspect illegal activities in spas or massage centres. In such cases, law enforcement is legally obligated to intervene. Failure to register an FIR in cases involving trafficking or forced exploitation can even attract liability under Section 199 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023.

However, the challenge lies in distinguishing legitimate wellness businesses from criminal enterprises. Prostitution itself is not illegal in India, though activities such as trafficking, running brothels, solicitation and pimping are punishable

offences under the Immoral Traffic (Prevention) Act.

India is also a signatory to the UN Convention against the Traffic in Persons (1953), which obligates states to prevent exploitation and trafficking. Domestic laws such as the 1956 Act were enacted to uphold these commitments and protect human dignity.

The Act also prescribes detailed procedures for raids under Section 15. Police must act on credible intelligence and follow procedural safeguards while conducting searches. While these provisions aim to protect individual rights, they also make enforcement more complex. In practice, the law intended to prevent exploitation has sometimes been misused against legitimate businesses, often due to social stigma and misunderstanding about the spa industry.

In cities operating under Police Commissionerate systems, commissioners possess wide powers to regulate activities affecting public morality and safety. Laws such as the Bombay Police Act (1951), Karnataka Police Act (1963) and the Madras City Police Act (1888) empower commissioners to frame rules governing entertainment and public establishments. These powers are sometimes used to regulate spas and massage centres in the absence of specific legislation.

Yet in an era where the government emphasises "ease of doing business" and regulatory uniformity, the absence of a standardised framework across states creates confusion for entrepreneurs and enforcement agencies alike.

Judicial Interventions
Courts have played an important role in clarifying the legal position of spas and massage centres.

The 2025 Sabnam Khatun case before the Punjab and Haryana High Court builds upon earlier judicial decisions that addressed similar issues. Several landmark rulings have shaped the legal understanding of such establishments.

In *Re: Ratnamala* (1962), the court clarified that anti-trafficking laws were designed to prevent commercialised vice rather than criminalise prostitution itself. This interpretation helped protect legitimate therapeutic practices while allowing prosecution of exploitative activities.

These judicial pronouncements have helped protect legitimate spa businesses from unwarranted interference while reinforcing the importance of preventing exploitation and trafficking.

Recommendations for Reform
Addressing the challenges faced

by the spa and massage industry requires a comprehensive regulatory overhaul.

First, states should adopt uniform legislation governing spas and massage centres. A clear regulatory framework should define licensing procedures, operational requirements and compliance standards. Such laws must strike a balance between enabling legitimate businesses and preventing illegal activities. Best practices from states such as Tamil Nadu and Delhi can serve as useful models.

Second, administrative reforms are equally important. Clear Standard Operating Procedures should guide police raids and inspections. Special Police Officers or Trafficking Police Officers, as envisaged under the Immoral Traffic (Prevention) Act, should supervise enforcement activities. Mechanisms for accountability must also be established to prevent misuse of authority.

Third, regulatory frameworks must prioritise rights protection. Policies should balance public order concerns with the constitutional rights of business owners, workers and clients. They must also incorporate the Supreme Court's 2022 directives on the protection and privacy rights of sex workers to ensure dignity and fairness for all stakeholders.

Finally, societal attitudes toward the spa and massage industry need to evolve. The stigma surrounding these services remains one of the sector's biggest challenges. While a small number of rogue operators may engage in illegal activities, the majority of spas operate within legal and ethical boundaries. Public awareness can help differentiate legitimate wellness services from exploitative practices.

The Way Forward
The regulation of spas and massage centres requires a careful balance between encouraging legitimate wellness practices and preventing misuse of such establishments for unlawful activities. As these centres continue to expand across urban landscapes, they represent both an opportunity for health promotion and a challenge for regulatory systems.

Effective governance will require cooperation between state authorities, industry stakeholders and law enforcement agencies. A transparent and well-designed regulatory framework can protect businesses, safeguard public welfare and uphold the dignity and rights of individuals.

Only through such balanced reforms can the spa and wellness industry grow responsibly while maintaining public trust.

Views expressed are personal

AMID MARITIME DISRUPTIONS IN WEST ASIA

Customs dept issues norms for handling return of export cargo

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Customs department has come out with norms for dealing with export cargo returning to Indian ports due to the closure of the Strait of Hormuz and disruptions in maritime routes amid the West Asia crisis.

The norms, issued by the CBIC on March 8 and to be valid for 15 days, stipulate that in all such cases the vessel shall be permitted to berth only at the same Indian port from which it departed, except in the case of transshipment.

The field offices under the Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC) will recover all export incentives, including IGST, drawback, etc., manually from such cargo, if they have already been disbursed, said the CBIC circular.

The CBIC said it has received representations from field formations indicating that, due to the closure of the Strait of Hormuz and the consequent disruption in maritime routes, certain vessels carrying export cargo from India are unable to reach their destination ports and are returning to Indian ports. It has been requested to prescribe a simplified procedure for handling such cargo.

Stating that the present circumstances constitute an exceptional situation affecting



The norms, issued by the CBIC on March 8 and to be valid for 15 days, stipulate that in all such cases the vessel shall be permitted to berth only at the same Indian port from which it departed, except in the case of transshipment

international shipping routes and export logistics, the CBIC prescribed procedures to facilitate trade and ensure expeditious handling of such cargo, where export cargo is brought back to Indian ports due to the closure of the Strait of Hormuz or similar disruptions.

Roughly, a fifth of global seaborne crude transits Hormuz daily. The Strait of Hormuz is a vital artery for seaborne oil transportation, with limited alternative routes. The crisis in West Asia has led to spiralling prices of global oil and natural gas. The Strait is a

narrow 33-kilometre passage connecting the Persian Gulf to the Arabian Sea.

On February 28, the US and Israel launched military strikes on Iran, which retaliated with attacks on American bases in the region, as well as Israel. The crisis in West Asia has escalated since then, with trade being affected.

The CBIC prescribed procedure for handling cargo in three situations.

In case the cargo is loaded on a vessel, and the vessel is within Indian territorial waters, and an Export General Mani-

Highlights

- » 'The CBIC has received representations from field formations that certain vessels carrying export cargo from India are unable to reach their destination and are returning to Indian ports'
- » The Strait of Hormuz is a vital artery for seaborne oil transportation, with limited alternative routes
- » The Strait is a narrow 33-kilometre passage connecting the Persian Gulf to the Arabian Sea

the vessel is beyond Indian territorial waters and is in international waters and returning without calling any foreign ports, the master of the vessel/captain shall submit an undertaking.

The containers may be offloaded at the port terminal without filing a Bill of Entry, subject to verification of SDM and related shipping documents. Details of such cancelled Shipping Bills shall be shared with the RBI, DGFT and other concerned agencies by ICEGATE.

In the third situation, where a vessel is beyond Indian territorial waters and is in international waters and returning to India after calling any foreign port without discharge of any container, the CBIC said such consignments shall be treated as exported out of India.

These containers may be offloaded at the port terminal without filing a Bill of Entry, subject to verification of SDM and related shipping documents. Details of such cancelled Shipping Bills shall be shared with RBI, DGFT and other concerned agencies by ICEGATE.

"In all such cases the vessel shall be permitted to berth only at the same India port from which it was departed, except in case of transshipment," the CBIC circular said.

Rupee tanks 39 paise to all-time low of 92.21 against US dollar

The rupee depreciated 18 paise against the US dollar on Friday to close at 91.82 against the American currency

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: The rupee crashed to its all-time closing low of 92.21 against the US dollar on Monday, losing 39 paise during the session, as global crude oil prices saw a sharp spike, and the greenback strengthened amid worsening conflict in the Middle East.

Withdrawal of foreign funds amid intense selling in domestic equity markets further pressured the rupee, forex traders said.

At the interbank foreign exchange, the rupee opened at 92.22 and rose briefly to 92.15 but kept losing ground through the session and recorded an intraday low of 92.35.

At the end of Monday's trading session, the rupee was quoted at 92.21, down 39 paise from its previous close.

The rupee depreciated 18 paise against the US dollar on Friday to close at 91.82 against the American currency.

"The rupee opened sharply lower, hitting a fresh record low of 92.35 on weak global markets and an overnight surge in crude oil prices. Oil prices surged around 25 per cent in the Asian session. Strong dollar and FII outflows also pressured the rupee," Anuj Choudhary, Research Analyst, Mirae Asset ShareKhan, said.

"We expect the rupee to trade with a negative bias on



Key Points

- » Apart from sharp spike in global crude oil prices, withdrawal of foreign funds amid intense selling in domestic equity markets further pressured the rupee
- » The dollar index, which gauges the greenback's strength against a basket of six currencies, was trading 0.35 per cent higher at 99.33
- » India's forex reserves jumped \$4.885 billion to an all-time high of \$728.494 billion during the week ended February 27, the Reserve Bank said on Friday

weak global market sentiments and a strong dollar amid geopolitical tensions in the Middle East. However, any intervention by the central bank may support the rupee at lower levels," he said, adding that the USD-INR spot price is expected to trade in the range of 92-92.80.

The dollar index, which gauges the greenback's strength against a basket of six curren-

cies, was trading 0.35 per cent higher at 99.33. Foreign institutional investors sold equities worth Rs 6,030.38 crore on a net basis on Friday, according to exchange data.

Meanwhile, India's forex reserves jumped \$4.885 billion to an all-time high of \$728.494 billion during the week ended February 27, the Reserve Bank said on Friday.

RBI injects ₹50,000 crore in banking system via OMO

MUMBAI: The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Monday injected Rs 50,000 crore into the banking system through Open Market Operation (OMO) purchases of government securities, according to a release.

The Reserve Bank of India purchased 6.33 per cent GS (Government Security) 2035 bonds worth Rs 13,507 crore, 6.01 per cent GS 2030 worth Rs 13,494 crore, 6.10 per cent GS 2031 of Rs 8,157 crore, 7.30 per cent GS 2053 of Rs 6,955 crore, 7.18 per cent GS 2033 worth Rs 4,479 crore, 6.92 per cent GS 2039 of Rs 2,304 crore, and 6.19 per cent GS 2034 of Rs 1,104 crore, it said.

The liquidity in the banking system, currently, is estimated to be in surplus of around Rs 2.41 lakh crore.

The OMO purchase auction was announced ahead of expected heavy outflows from the banking system due to advance tax and Goods and Services Tax (GST) payments scheduled later this month.

This comes even as liquidity conditions in the banking system currently remain in a significant surplus of Rs 3.02 lakh crore.

As per RBI data, it has infused Rs 2.50 lakh crore through OMO purchases of government securities so far since the start of this calendar year. PFI

Government buys back ₹6,309 cr G-sec in RBI's switch auction

The securities repurchased by the government were part of the scheduled bonds set to mature in the next fiscal

MUMBAI: The government has bought back G-secs worth Rs 6,309 crore from the switch auction conducted by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), and has issued bonds worth Rs 6,431.797 crore, according to a release.

Government securities (G-Secs) are low-risk debt instruments that are issued by the government and offer fixed returns and are backed by a sovereign guarantee.

The securities repurchased by the government were part of the scheduled bonds set to mature in the next financial year.

These included Rs 1,684

crore of 7.33 per cent GS 2026, Rs 1,035 crore of 5.74 per cent GS 2026, Rs 590 crore of 8.15 per cent GS 2026, and Rs 3,000 crore of 8.24 per cent GS 2027, the release said.

In exchange, the government issued Rs 1,719.236 crore of 6.57 per cent GS 2033, Rs 986.526 crore of 7.62 per cent GS 2039, Rs 605.609 crore of 6.57 per cent GS 2033, and Rs 3,120.426 crore of 7.40 per cent GS 2062, the release added.

This is the fourth switch auction by the RBI since February.

In a bond switch, the government replaces bonds matur-

ing in the near-term with long-term instruments.

The switch operation is expected to ease redemption pressure in the next financial year, when government bond maturities worth Rs 5.47 lakh crore are due.

With gross market borrowing already budgeted at Rs 17.2 lakh crore, the move helps in smoothening the maturity profile and managing the repayment obligations more effectively.

Prior to this, Reserve Bank had conducted three switch auctions and bought back securities worth Rs 98,591.701 crore, RBI data showed. PFI

Sebi examining CSE's application for voluntary exit from business

NEW DELHI: Capital market regulator Sebi is examining the application seeking voluntary exit of the Calcutta Stock Exchange (CSE) from its business, Minister of State for Finance Pankaj Chaudhary said on Monday.

In a written reply to a question in the Lok Sabha, Chaudhary said Sebi has constituted a Working Group on the matter and appointed a valuation agency for verification and valuation of CSE's assets and liabilities.

Certain information sought by Sebi from CSE is awaited, he said. "Sebi would be passing a speaking order giving an exit to CSE from stock exchange business after taking a view on exclusively listed companies of CSE, its assets and liabilities, and relaxation from any reg-



ulations in order to facilitate exit," he said.

The Calcutta Stock Exchange (CSE), in its February 18, 2025, letter to the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi), sought voluntary exit as a Stock Exchange under the Sebi Exit Policy for stock exchanges. "The proposal is at the stage of examination before SEBI," Chaudhary said.

Trading on the CSE platform stopped in April 2013.

The Calcutta High Court, in its orders dated February

'Sebi has appointed a valuation agency for verification and valuation of CSE's assets and liabilities'

19, 2024 and August 19, 2024, granted time to CSE to comply with the requirements relating to clearing corporation arrangements and net worth under the Securities Contracts (Regulation) (Stock Exchanges and Clearing Corporations) Regulations, 2018.

The said requirements were not achieved within the stipulated period by CSE. Subsequently, CSE submitted an application on February 18, 2025, seeking exit from the stock exchange business. PFI

FTAs to provide huge export opportunities for pharma, healthcare sectors: Goyal

NEW DELHI: The nine free trade agreements (FTAs) finalised by India in the last four years will provide huge business opportunities for the domestic pharma and healthcare sectors, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said on Monday.

India has finalised FTAs with the UK, Mauritius, Australia, the US, European Union, four-nation bloc EFTA, Oman, the UAE and New Zealand.

While the pacts with Mauritius, Australia, the UAE and EFTA are implemented, the remaining are likely to

come into force soon. "These agreements open new opportunities for pharmaceuticals, healthcare and medtech sectors," Goyal said in a post-Budget webinar.

He suggested the industry to focus on taking greater advantage of these pacts and developing a strong healthcare ecosystem.

"We need to develop a comprehensive, holistic and integrated healthcare system," he said. The minister informed that FTA negotiations with the Gulf Cooperation Council and Eurasia are progressing well. PFI

Tech Mahindra rejects speculation on headcount reduction



NEW DELHI: IT services company Tech Mahindra on Monday strongly denied market speculations around a possible significant reduction in headcount.

Given the speculation, Tech Mahindra said it finds it necessary to clarify that no such proposal is under consideration.

The company cited calls and certain social media posts regarding a "market rumour" of a potential significant reduction in headcount.

"The company has received calls and has noted certain social media posts regarding a market rumour of a potential significant reduction in headcount.

"In view of the above speculation, the company on its own accord considers it necessary to clarify to the Stock Exchanges that no such proposal is under consideration and categorically denies any such market rumours," it added. PFI

Enough fertiliser stock for kharif, gas supply disruption a concern: FAI

As per official data, total fertiliser reserves stood at 177.31 lakh tonnes as of March 6, up 36.5 per cent from 129.85 lakh tonnes a year earlier

NEW DELHI: India's fertiliser stockpiles are adequate to meet the demands of the upcoming kharif season, but a 40 per cent curtailment in gas supply and ongoing geopolitical tensions in West Asia have raised concerns over domestic urea production and the cost of imports, the Fertiliser Association of India (FAI) said Monday.

"At present, the immediate availability of fertilisers looks to be okay. The stock will be sufficient to meet the requirement of the forthcoming kharif season, although some shortage in supply of imported fertilisers is

expected," FAI Director General Chaudhari Suresh Kumar said.

As per official data, total fertiliser reserves stood at 177.31 lakh tonnes as of March 6, up 36.5 per cent from 129.85 lakh tonnes a year earlier.

Stocks of urea, the most consumed fertiliser and one heavily dependent on natural gas as feedstock, stood at 59.30 lakh tonnes. Diammonium phosphate (DAP) inventories were at 25.13 lakh tonnes, while NPKS fertiliser reserves reached 55.87 lakh tonnes.

Despite the comfortable current inventory, Kumar flagged

gas supply as the sector's central concern. "Our worry is about gas supply, which is curtailed up to 40 per cent. If the war continues, it will impact domestic production of urea for the rabi season," he said, adding that the industry expects the government to prioritise gas allocation to the fertiliser sector.

India faces up to 40 per cent cuts in LNG supply to urea producers due to Qatar's production pause amid the West Asia conflict. Companies operating multiple plants are already adapting, they are shutting down one plant while keeping

CLOSER LOOK

» Stocks of urea, the most consumed fertiliser and one heavily dependent on natural gas as feedstock, stood at 59.30 lakh tonnes

» Diammonium phosphate (DAP) inventories were at 25.13 lakh tonnes, while NPKS fertiliser reserves reached 55.87 lakh tonnes

others running to manage operations within the constraints of reduced gas availability. The summer months of March to May, typically a flat season for the industry, are also being used for routine maintenance, energy

efficiency work and repairs.

Fertiliser companies have agreed to premonition scheduled plant shutdowns to March so that firms can utilise the period of global disruption without affecting peak-season

output. "Fertiliser companies are cautious. FAI is monitoring the situation," Kumar said.

The government is in discussions with countries including China to boost supplies of DAP, urea and water-soluble fertilisers, Kumar said. It has already imported 98 lakh tonnes of finished fertilisers up to February 2026, with a further 17 lakh tonnes of shipments lined up for delivery over the next three months, as per the official data.

Indian companies have also secured long-term supply agreements with major international producers for phosphatic and

potassic (P&K) fertilisers to guard against regional pricing and supply volatility.

The FAI DG said global prices of urea, DAP and sulphur have risen, and are expected to have an impact on domestic rates. "It is up to the government to subsidise. I am sure the government will protect the interests of farmers," Kumar said.

The Department of Fertilisers echoed that position last week, saying: "Farmers are the priority of the government, and their interests will not be compromised under any circumstances." Gas allocation to

the fertiliser sector has been accorded top national priority following a high-level review meeting, the department added.

India imports around 30 per cent of its fertiliser requirement, with the Middle East accounting for 40 per cent of those imports. The region also supplies roughly 30 per cent of key raw materials and intermediates — including rock phosphate, phosphoric acid and muriate of potash. Rating agency Crisil has warned that ongoing regional uncertainties could disrupt supply chains & push up international prices for urea and DAP. PFI

ADEQUATE STOCK TO MEET ANY CONTINGENCY

No immediate increase in petrol and diesel prices: Govt sources

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Petrol and diesel prices will not be increased for now despite international crude oil rates crossing \$100 per barrel, government sources said on Monday, even as authorities stepped up efforts to maintain uninterrupted fuel supply lines across the country.

As the conflict in West Asia entered the tenth day, world markets plummeted, and Brent crude oil, the international standard, surged to nearly \$120 a barrel, about 65 per cent higher than when the war started, before retreating.

Top government sources said the government is closely monitoring global oil markets, but there is no immediate plan to raise retail fuel prices. Oil marketing companies are expected to absorb the current cost pressure for the time being.

While the country has adequate stocks of both crude oil and fuels to meet requirements for the next 6-8 weeks, the government has tweaked the policy for ordering a cooking gas LPG refill.

The minimum gap for booking a domestic LPG refill has been increased to 25 days from the current 21 days, a move aimed at preventing hoarding and ensuring equitable distribution of cylinders.

Sources said the minimum



Oil marketing companies are expected to absorb the current cost pressure for the time being

waiting period for booking a domestic LPG cylinder refill increased from 21 days to 25 days to prevent hoarding.

Average households consume 7-8 LPG cylinders of 14.2 kg in a year and should normally not need a refill in less than 6 weeks, they said, adding the refill booking period has been increased to prevent hoarding and creation of artificial scarcity in the market.

The oil companies have an adequate stock of LPG, they added. Sources said the government is closely monitoring the evolving global energy situation and has taken steps to ensure that supply chains remain stable.

The widening conflict in the Middle East, which began on

Highlights

- While the country has adequate stocks of both crude oil and fuels to meet requirements for the next 6-8 weeks
- The government has tweaked the policy for ordering a cooking gas LPG refill
- The minimum gap for booking a domestic LPG refill has been jumped to 25 days from the current 21 days

February 28 when the United States and Israel carried out strikes on Iran, followed by retaliatory attacks from Tehran, has disrupted energy flows through the Strait of Hormuz.

The narrow shipping corridor is a crucial artery for India's energy supplies, with about 40-50 per cent of the country's crude oil imports and nearly 85-90 per cent of its LPG shipments from Gulf nations passing through the route.

Sources said that while there is enough crude oil available from alternative sources, such as Russia, replacing any loss of LPG supplies is more time-consuming, as other alternative sources are largely located in the United States and Canada.

To ensure uninterrupted supplies, the government has ordered refineries to maximise LPG production and not use any of its streams for making petrochemicals.

On petrol and diesel, the situation is "very comfortable", one of the sources said. "Every petrol pump in the country is functioning, every piped natural gas (to household kitchens) is operational, every CNG station is open," he said. "There is no cause for panic." For India, which imports 88 per cent of its requirement of crude oil, which is turned into fuels like petrol and diesel at refineries, higher global prices translate into a larger import bill and potential inflationary pressures.

However, retail fuel prices are not expected to be raised immediately, as the government continues to follow a calibrated policy of allowing companies to build margins when international prices are low and cushioning consumers when rates rise, sources said.

Retail petrol and diesel prices have been on a freeze since April 2022, with fuel retailers like Indian Oil Corporation, Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd and Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd absorbing losses when crude prices are high and making profits when rates are low.

This meant that when global

fuel prices went up in response to elevated crude prices, prices were stable in India. And when softening of crude prices pushed down fuel rates globally, rates in India remained unchanged.

The government wants to continue to shield consumers, and the same policy will continue unless there is a huge spike in crude prices, they said.

India imports 88 per cent of its crude oil needs and roughly half of its natural gas requirement. These mostly come via the Strait of Hormuz.

As India scouts for more LPG and gas supplies, some recalibration in supplies to different sectors is being done.

Following the US and Israeli attacks on Iranian government, military and nuclear facilities, Iran warned shipping away from the strait, and insurers withdrew coverage, effectively halting tanker movements.

"They (oil companies) have enough cushion to sustain this kind of price spike," a source with direct knowledge of the matter said. "We have seen prices rise to \$119 per barrel in June 2022 in the aftermath of Russia's invasion of Ukraine. That year, they had nominal profits, but in FY24, they posted record Rs 81,000 crore profit."

This year, the three companies have posted Rs 23,743 crore profit in the December quarter alone.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The impact of global crude price rise on inflation is not estimated to be substantial at this point as India's inflation is near the lower bound, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said on Monday.

In reply to a written question in the Lok Sabha, Sitharaman said the price of both global crude oil and the Indian basket has been on a declining trajectory for the past one year, till the geo-political clashes commenced in West Asia on February 28, 2026.

"Between the end of February and until March 2, 2026, the Crude Oil FOB Price (Indian Basket) rose from \$69.01/barrel to \$80.16/barrel. Given that India's inflation is near the lower bound, the impact on inflation is not estimated to be substantial at this point," Sitharaman said.

She was replying to a question on whether the government has reviewed the impact of rising global crude oil prices on inflation in the country. Global crude prices have been rising since February 28 when the US and Israel launched military strikes on Iran who retaliated with attacks on US positions in the region, as well as Israel.

Replying to the question, the minister said that RBI's Monetary Policy Report in October 2025, had estimated that if crude oil prices are higher by 10 per cent than the baseline assumptions, and



Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman

The average retail inflation measured by the Consumer Price Index declined from 5.4 per cent in 2023-24 to 4.6 per cent in 2024-25 and further to 1.8 per cent in 2025-26 (April – January)

assuming full pass-through to domestic prices, inflation could turn out to be higher by 30 basis points.

However, the medium-term impact of the global crude oil price rise on inflation depends on several factors, including exchange rate movements, global demand and supply situation, monetary policy transmission, the state of general inflation, and the extent of the indirect pass-through.

The average retail inflation measured by the Consumer Price Index declined from 5.4 per cent in 2023-24 to 4.6 per cent in 2024-25 and further to 1.8 per cent in 2025-26 (April

– January).

The headline inflation for January 2026 stood at 2.75 per cent and is near the lower bound of the RBI's inflation tolerance band of 4 per cent $\pm$ 2 per cent.

As part of inflation management, the Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) has reduced the policy rate by 125 basis points cumulatively since February 2025, Sitharaman said.

Further, the government has also undertaken a series of administrative measures, including fiscal and trade policy, to control inflation and mitigate its impact on the common citizen.

These include, inter alia, augmentation of buffer stocks for essential food items, strategic sales of procured grains in the open market, facilitation of imports and export curbs during periods of short supply, implementation of stock limits to push more supplies of select commodities into the market, retail sales of select food items under the Bharat brand at subsidised rates, market intervention for perishable horticultural and agricultural commodities, reduction in fuel taxes, creation of scientific storage capacity.

Also, the government has increased the disposable income of individuals by exempting annual incomes up to Rs 12 lakh (and Rs 12.75 lakh for salaried individuals with standard deduction) from income tax and the recent rationalisation of Good and Services Tax (GST) rates.

THIRTY YEARS OF NIFTY 50



The National Stock Exchange of India Ltd. (NSE) on Monday celebrated 30 years of the Nifty 50 Index, India's flagship equity benchmark and one of the most widely tracked indices globally. The milestone event was held at NSE's Exchange Plaza in Mumbai. The celebrations were graced by Tuhin Kanta Pandey, Chairman, Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI), as Chief Guest, and S Gurumurthy, Writer, Strategic Thinker and Independent Director at the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), as Distinguished Guest of Honour. They were joined by Srinivas Injeti, Chairman, NSE, and Ashishkumar Chauhan, MD & CEO, NSE.

FTA with EU, other nations will help MSME sector's access to developed mkts: Prasada

'MSMEs—the backbone of Indian economy—must focus on quality-led growth & move beyond scale-driven, low-cost manufacturing'

NEW DELHI: Recent Free Trade Agreements (FTAs) with regions including the EU, the UK, Australia and New Zealand will help India's MSME sector gain access to a large share of developed markets, creating a significant opportunity for domestic manufacturers to expand exports and integrate with global supply chains, said Jitin Prasada.

Speaking at the FICCI FLO National MSME Awards ceremony, Prasada, Minister of State for Commerce and Industry and Electronics and IT, said MSMEs—the backbone of the Indian economy—must focus on quality-led growth and move beyond scale-driven, low-cost manufacturing.

"With nearly 65 per cent of developed markets covered under FTAs, these countries demand high-quality products. Indian consumers, including those in rural areas with digital access, also increasingly prefer quality goods," he said, adding that zero-duty access should not be seen as a route for sub-standard imports into India.

Prasada said FTAs are expected to boost MSME exports by providing fair and inclusive market access and helping small businesses integrate into global value chains.

With India's population of more than 1.4 bil-



lion becoming increasingly aspirational, the country itself represents a vast and expanding market for quality products and services, he added, urging entrepreneurs to produce globally competitive goods that meet international standards.

He also highlighted the growing role of artificial intelligence (AI) across sectors such as healthcare, transportation, manufacturing and services.

MSMEs should adopt AI technologies to enhance productivity, improve efficiency and support better decision-making while reducing routine operational burdens, he said.

Subhansu Sekhar Acharya, Chairman & MD of the National Small Industries Corporation (NSIC),

emphasised the importance of strengthening women-led enterprises through targeted support, digital empowerment and skill development.

He noted that NSIC has been promoting the Trade Enablement & Marketing (TEAM) initiative, which aims to onboard five lakh MSMEs onto the Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC) platform, with a goal that 50 per cent of them are women-led enterprises.

FICCI Ladies Organisation (FLO) National President Poonam Sharma, said women entrepreneurs are emerging as key drivers of inclusive economic growth.

She said FLO has been working to strengthen women's economic participation through skill development, entrepreneurship support,

Closer Look

» 'With nearly 65% of developed markets covered under FTAs, these countries demand high-quality products,' Jitin Prasada said

» MSMEs should adopt AI technologies to enhance productivity, improve efficiency, the minister said

policy advocacy and leadership mentoring.

The organisation has also launched the FLO MSME Assist Cell to provide women entrepreneurs with a comprehensive support ecosystem.

The cell connects women entrepreneurs with industry experts and mentors in areas such as funding, marketing, business expansion strategies, technology adoption and skill development, enabling them not only to start businesses but also to scale and sustain them successfully.

Eleven women MSME entrepreneurs were honoured at the event. Among those present were MP Anurag Sharma & Ruby Garg, who heads FLO's MSME initiatives. MPOST

Basic savings, Jan Dhan accounts not subject to penalty for non having minimum balance

NEW DELHI: About 72 crore Basic Savings Bank Deposit Accounts (BSBDAs), including those under the PM Jan Dhan scheme, are not subject to any penal charges for non-maintenance of minimum balance, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said on Monday.

In a written reply to a question in the Lok Sabha, she said banks offer zero-balance savings accounts facility in Basic Savings Bank Deposit Accounts (BSBDAs), including the accounts opened under the Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY), to ensure universal access to banking facilities, particularly for unbanked, vulnerable and small depositors, and to promote financial inclusion.

These accounts do not require maintenance of any minimum balance, and the account holders are provided basic banking services such as deposits, withdrawals and ATM access free of charge, without levy of any penal charges.

"Approximately 72 crore BSBDAs,



including PMJDY accounts, are not subject to any penal charges for non-maintenance of minimum balance," Sitharaman said.

For other accounts, banks may levy charges for non-maintenance of Minimum Monthly Average Balance (MAB) in accordance with their board-approved policies and the extant instructions of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), which require that such charges be reasonable, transparent and broadly aligned with the cost of providing the services.

During FY 2022-23 to FY 2024-25, Public Sector Banks (PSBs) have col-

lected Rs 8,092.83 crore from current account and savings account holders on account of non-maintenance of MAB.

"The amount of Rs 8,092.83 crore collected over the last three financial years constitutes approximately 0.23 per cent of the total income of Public Sector Banks during the same period, indicating that such charges form only a very small proportion of banks' income and are primarily aligned with the cost of providing banking services rather than revenue generation through penalties," Sitharaman said.

To further enhance customer-centricity and promote inclusive banking, PSBs have reviewed their service charge structures. In accordance with board-approved policies and commercial considerations, SBI had completely waived off penal charges for non-maintenance of minimum MAB in savings accounts since March 2020. In 2025, nine PSBs have waived off such charges and two rationalised minimum balance charges. PTI

'Saudi Aramco reducing output at two oilfields'

RIYADH: Saudi oil giant Aramco has begun cutting output at two of its oilfields, two sources said on Monday, after the vital Strait of Hormuz was choked by the US-Israeli war on Iran and subsequent attacks on the waterway.

It was not immediately clear at which fields and by how much production was being curtailed, Reuters reported.

The reductions by the world's top oil exporter underscore the severe logistical bot-

tlenecks in the region since the US and Israel began attacking Iran on February 28 and Tehran responded by launching hundreds of missiles and drones, including at Gulf countries hosting U.S. military facilities.

Several of Saudi Arabia's neighbours have also cut production as shipping in the oil transit chokepoint, carrying roughly a fifth of global oil and liquefied natural gas flows, has ground to a near halt. AGENCIES

मध्यप्रदेश लघु उद्योग निगम मर्या. कार्यालय महाप्रबंधक (संपदा/निर्माण), संभाग क्र. 01, भोपाल पंचानन भवन, द्वितीय तल, मालवीय नगर, भोपाल (म.प्र.) दूरभाष क्र. : 0755-2673196, E-mail : laghubp01@gmail.com क्रमांक : लउनि/निर्माण/संभाग क्र.1, भोपाल/2025-26/49 भोपाल, दिनांक 06.03.2026 निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना निम्न कार्यो की निविदा ई-टेंडरिंग पद्धति से वेबसाइट https://www.mptenders.gov.in पर आमंत्रित की जाती हैं:- कार्य का नाम - 1. शासकीय होम्योपैथी मेडिकल महाविद्यालय भोपाल के कन्या छात्रावास भवन का प्रथम, द्वितीय तल में सिविल, इंटिरियर, रिनोवेशन एवं रजिस्ट्रार आफिस एवं होम्योपैथी मेडिकल कालेज में फायर फायटिंग सिस्टम का कार्य, अनुमानित लागत राशि रु. 260.05 लाख। 2. संचालनालय पशुपालन एवं डेयरी कामधेनु भवन वैशाली नगर भोपाल के भूतल कॉल सेंटर, योजना सेवशन, जांच एवं सामान्य सेवशन में इंटिरियर रिनोवेशन, फर्नीशिंग, आंतरिक विद्युतीकरण, सिविल एवं अन्य अलाइड कार्य एवं एम.पी.आई.डी.सी. क्षेत्रीय कार्यालय नर्मदापुरम कार्यालय में इंटिरियर रिनोवेशन कार्य, अनुमानित लागत राशि रु. 207.07 लाख। 3. राज्य शिक्षा केन्द्र पुस्तक भवन, अररा हिल्स भोपाल कार्यालय भवन में प्रथम तल पर स्थित लायब्रेरी हॉल का इंटिरियर, रिनोवेशन, फर्नीशिंग मय आंतरिक विद्युतीकरण कार्य, अनुमानित लागत राशि रु. 121.19 लाख। निविदाओं की समस्त जानकारी उक्त वेबसाइट पर दी जावेगी। निविदाओं में कोई संशोधन न परिवर्तन किया जाता है, तो वह उपरोक्त वेबसाइट पर देखा जा सकता है। बिना कोई कारण बताये निविदा को स्वीकृत अथवा निरस्त करने का अधिकार निगम के पास सुरक्षित है। म.प्र. माध्यम/124838/2026 महाप्रबंधक (सं.नि.)

NSE may onboard merchant bankers for IPO this month: NSE MD Ashish Chauhan

MUMBAI: The National Stock Exchange is likely to appoint merchant bankers for its long-awaited initial public offering (IPO) in March, its Managing Director and CEO Ashish Kumar Chauhan said.

"The process is still on for determining the merchant bankers. It should happen in the month of March," Chauhan told reporters on the sidelines of the National Stock Exchange of India's (NSE) celebration of 30 years of NIFTY 50.

According to Chauhan, the valuation and final size of the IPO will be determined only after the merchant bankers are appointed and the formal process begins.

"Valuation is usually determined by the merchant bankers. They are yet to be appointed. So, I don't know what the final amounts will be," he said.

On regulatory aspects, Chauhan said Sebi rules allowing exchanges to go public with a lower public



float would not materially affect the timeline.

"Sebi regulations have allowed NSE-like companies to go with a smaller float because we don't have an identifiable promoter," he said.

Unlike many listed companies, no single entity holds a controlling stake in NSE that can be classified as a promoter, he added.

While Chauhan did not specify a launch timeline, he indicated that the exchange hopes the IPO could reach the market by the fourth quarter of the next financial year. PTI

यूनियन बैंक ऑफ इंडिया Union Bank of India UNION BANK OF INDIA NEW DELHI - PATPARGANJ BRANCH, Address at - 1 P EXTENSION, PLATO PUBLIC SCHOOL, NEAR MEENA APARTMENT, PATPARGANJ, NEW DELHI-110092 E-Mail ID : ubin0921343@unionbankofindia.bank DEMAND NOTICE UNDER SEC.13 (2) Ref. 21342/DN/2025-26/ Date: 05/02/2026 Place : NEW DELHI To 1. MR. ASEEM BHARDWAJ (Borrower) At: FLAT NO 1502, TOWER 17, LOTUS BOULEVARD, SECTOR 100, NOIDA, GAUTAM BUDDH NAGAR, UP-201301, ALSO AT : WIRPRO LTD, PLOT NO. 2,3,4, KNOWLEDGE PARK-4, GAUTAM BUDDH NAGAR, GREATER NOIDA, UP-201308. ALSO AT: A-54, ISHAN-3, PRAHALAD NAGAR, NEAR SHARNAM-10, AHMADABAD, GUJARAT-380015 ALSO AT: A-44, 45, SECTOR -62, DLF IT PARK, NOIDA, UTTAR PRADESH-201101 Sir/Madam, Notice under Sec.13 (2) read with Sec.13 (3) of Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002. You are hereby called upon to pay the following credit facilities from our NEW DELHI-PATPARGANJ Branch and failed to pay the dues/installment / interest / operate the accounts satisfactorily and hence, in terms of the RBI guidelines as to the Income Recognition and Prudential Accounting Norms, your account/s has /have been classified as Non-Performing Asset as on 04/02/2026. As on 04/02/2026 a sum of Rs.563400.84 (Rupees Five Lakh Sixty Three Thousand Four Hundred and Paise Eighty Four Only) is outstanding in your account/s. The particulars of amount due to the Bank from No. 1 of you in respect of the aforesaid account/s are as under: Type of Facility Outstanding amount as on date 04.02.2026 Un applied interest Penal Interest (Simple) Cost/ Charges incurred by Bank Total dues VL001 524021.00 39379.84 0 0 563400.84 Total Dues 563400.84 To secure the repayment of the monies due or the monies that may become due to the Bank, MR. ASEEM BHARDWAJ had/have executed documents on 06/08/2022 and created security interest by way of: Hypothecation of Movable Property - Four-Wheeler (Car described herein below: ✓ Maker/Brand : Volkswagen India Pvt. Ltd. ✓ Model : Skoda -Kushaq Style 1.0 TSI MT ✓ Registration No : UP16DJ3281 ✓ Registration Dt.: 10/08/2022 ✓ Engine No.: DTB073156 ✓ Chassis No.: MEXKPGPA6NG028273 Therefore, You are hereby called upon in terms of section 13(2) of the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, to pay a sum of Rs. 563400.84 together with further interest and Charges at the contractual rate as per the terms and conditions of loan documents executed by you and discharge your liabilities in full within 60 days from the date of receipt of this notice, failing which, we shall be constrained to enforce the aforesaid securities by exercising any or all of the rights given under the said Act. As per section 13 (1) of the Act, on receipt of this notice you are restrained / prevented from disposing of or dealing with the above securities without the consent of the bank. Your attention is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of Section 13 of the SARFAESI in respect of respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets. Yours Faithfully Authorised Officer

'US MILITARY MAY BEAR CULPABILITY'

Probe suggests it was US that struck Iranian school, killing 165

JERUSALEM: The investigative group Bellingcat says the newly released video “appears to contradict” US President Donald Trump’s claim that Iran was responsible for an explosion at an Iranian school that killed over 165 people at the start of the war raging in the Mideast.

It comes as mounting evidence points to US culpability for the Feb. 28 strike, which hit a school adjacent to a Revolutionary Guard base in Minab, Iran, in the country’s southern Hormozgan Province. Experts interviewed by The Associated Press, citing satellite image analysis, say the school was likely struck amid a quick succession of bombs dropped on the compound.

The video shared by Bellingcat is a three-second clip of a video taken the day the school was struck and circulated Sunday by Iran’s semi-official Mehr news agency. The video shows a munition falling on a building, sending a dark plume into the air that mingles with smoke that likely came



Graves prepared for victims following a reported strike on a girls' school in Minab

AP/PTI

from earlier strikes on the compound. Trevor Ball, a Bellingcat researcher, geolocated the video to a site near the school, some-

thing also done by the AP. Ball identified the munition as a Tomahawk cruise missile, which only the US is known to

possess in this war. It’s the first evidence of a munition used in the strike. US Central Command has acknowledged using

Highlights

- » It comes as mounting evidence points to US culpability for the Feb. 28 strike
- » The school was likely struck amid a quick succession of bombs dropped on the compound
- » Trevor Ball, a Bellingcat researcher, geolocated the video to a site near the school, something also done by the AP

Tomahawk missiles in this war and even released a photo of the USS Spruance, part of the USS Abraham Lincoln aircraft carrier group located within range of the school, firing a Tomahawk missile on Feb. 28. Complicating any assessment of the incident is the lack of images of bomb fragments from the blast. No independent agency has reached the site during the war to investigate.

AGENCIES

PHOTOS AND VIDEOS SHOWED EXCAVATORS DIGGING THROUGH THE COLLAPSED MOUND IN THE COUNTRY

Photos and videos released by the National Search and Rescue Agency showed excavators digging through the collapsed mound, where several garbage trucks and small food stalls were buried. The National Disaster Management Agency’s spokesperson, Abdul Muhari, urged strict safety protocols during the ongoing search, noting that weather forecasts for the next two days indicate potential rain across Jakarta and its nearby satellite cities.

He warned that the unstable collapsed material could trigger additional ground movement, putting rescue teams at further risk. Sunday’s deadly collapse renewed scrutiny of Bantargebang, a critical but overwhelmed landfill that receives most of Greater Jakarta’s daily household waste.

AGENCIES

Newly elected NA members take oath in Nepal

KATHMANDU: Nepal’s newly elected members of the National Assembly took the oath of office on Monday.

National Assembly (NA) Chairman Narayan Prasad Dahal administered the oath of office and secrecy to 17 out of 18 NA members at a ceremony in the Parliament building. They were elected to the National Assembly on January 25 this year.

In the 59-seat NA, the members have six year’s term. However, one-third of them get their terms expired every two years as per the constitution.

The newly elected NA members taking oath include Khamma Bahadur Khati, Gita Devkota, Chandra Bahadur KC, Jagat Timalisina, Dharmendra Paswan, and Prem Prasad Dangal.

Mahanth Thakur, Ranjit Karn, Ram Kumari Jhankri, Rekha Kumari Jha, Roshani Meche, Lalit Jung Shahi, Lila Kumari Bhandari, Basudev Ghimire, Samjhana Devkota, Sunil Bahadur Thapa and Somnath Portel, according to sources at the Parliament secretariat.

One of the members of the NA, Mia Rakhal, was absent during the ceremony.

AGENCIES

UK PM Starmer speaks to US Prez Trump after latest rebuke over Iran

LONDON: British Prime Minister Keir Starmer has spoken to Donald Trump to discuss the situation in West Asia after the US President had been extremely critical of the UK’s response to the strikes on Iran.

Trump took to social media to dismiss Starmer’s plan to send aircraft carriers to the region as an attempt to join wars “already won”.

Downing Street released a readout of the Trump-Starmer call on Sunday, seen as an effort to smooth over the so-called UK-US “special relationship”.

“The leaders began by discussing the latest situ-



British Prime Minister Keir Starmer has spoken to Donald Trump

FILE PHOTO/RUTERS

Downing Street spokesperson said.

“The Prime Minister also shared his heartfelt condolences with President Trump and the American people following the deaths of six US soldiers.

They looked forward to speaking again soon,” the spokesperson said.

It came after the Ministry of Defence (MoD) confirmed that one of the UK’s two aircraft carriers has been placed on advanced readiness, with the crew of HMS Prince of Wales docked in Portsmouth told they must be ready to leave within days.

AGENCIES

Japan prepares 1st domestically built long-range missile

The upgraded Type-12 land-to-ship missiles will be deployed by the end of March

TOKYO: Japan is preparing to deploy its first batch of domestically developed long-range missiles, with their launchers arriving at an army camp Monday as the country accelerates its offensive capability in response to rising challenges in the region.

The upgraded Type-12 land-to-ship missiles will be deployed at Camp Kengun in Japan’s southwestern prefecture of Kumamoto by the end of March, completing the process of deployment, Chief Cabinet Secretary Minoru Kihara said.

Army vehicles carrying their launchers and other equipment arrived early in the morning in



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

a highly secretive mission criticized by local residents who protested outside the camp. Opponents have complained about the lack of transparency and said the deployment

Key Points

- » The upgraded Type-12 land-to-ship missiles will be deployed at Camp Kengun
- » Army vehicles carrying their launchers and other equipment arrived early in the morning in a highly secretive mission

one year as Japan accelerates a military buildup in the southwestern region as China escalates tension around Taiwan, the self-governing island Beijing claims as its own.

The upgraded Type-12 missile, developed and produced by Mitsubishi Heavy Industries, has a range of about 1,000 km and can reach mainland China, a significant extension from the 200-km range of the original. It will be deployed next at Camp Fuji in Shizuoka, west of Tokyo, later this year.

Japan considers China a growing security threat and has pushed a military buildup

on southwestern islands near the East China Sea. It has deployed PAC-3 interceptors and midrange surface-to-air missiles on many of the islands, including Okinawa, Ishigaki and Miyako.

Defence Minister Shinjiro Koizumi last month said Japan will deploy the midrange SAMs on Japan’s westernmost island of Yonaguni, just east of Taiwan, by March 2031.

Tensions have escalated further since Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi’s comment soon after taking office that any Chinese military action against Taiwan could be grounds for a Japanese military response.

AGENCIES

Sport

Partners in time

The Surya–Gambhir effect shaped fearless India as they rule T20 World

MEENAKSHI RAO

AHMEDABAD: India’s triumphant campaign in the ICC Men’s T20 World Cup was not merely about runs, wickets or shattered records. At its heart lay a powerful partnership — the contrasting yet complementary leadership of captain Suryakumar Yadav and head coach Gautam Gambhir.

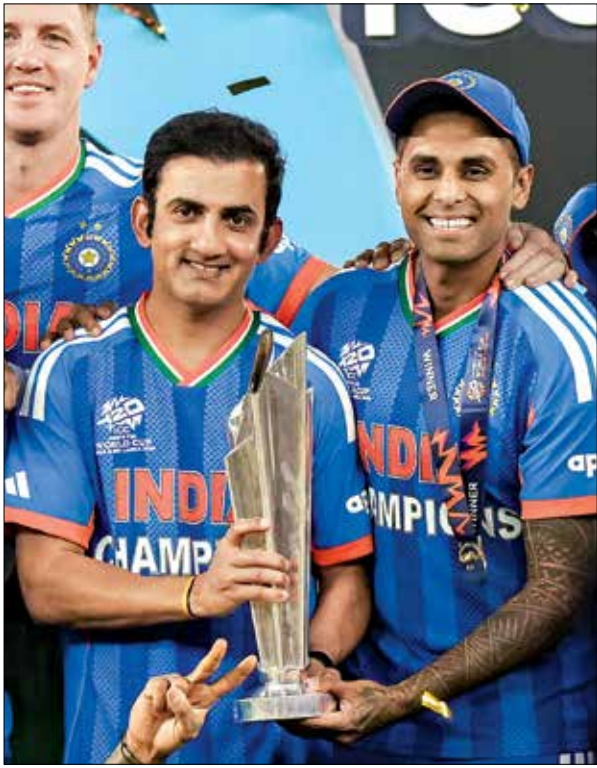
On the surface, the two could hardly appear more different. Surya is expressive, relaxed and deeply personal in the way he connects with teammates. Gambhir, by contrast, is intense, blunt and fiercely ideological about how the game must be played.

Yet inside the dressing room, their philosophies have aligned almost perfectly.

The result has been a team playing fearless cricket with absolute clarity of purpose.

For Surya, leadership begins with relationships. The Indian skipper prefers to call himself a “leader” rather than a captain — a reflection of how he views his role within the squad.

“I think it’s important to sit together and understand what this team demands,” Surya said after India’s title win. “When someone is not doing well, you spend time with him, take him



Gautam Gambhir and Suryakumar Yadav pose with the trophy

PTI

out for dinners, talk to him. Those are the players who at the right time will do something special for you.”

His leadership style is rooted in empathy and communication. Surya believes players perform best when they

feel secure and heard.

“Freedom of speech in the dressing room is very important,” he said. “If you don’t listen to everyone, you can’t take everyone together and win a trophy.”

Gambhir’s philosophy,

1
India became the first team to score 250-plus in successive men’s T20Is

meanwhile, revolves around fearless cricket. The head coach has repeatedly stressed that India’s success has come from shedding conservative thinking in T20 cricket.

“The most important thing in this format is that you can’t be afraid of losing,” Gambhir said. “If you are afraid of losing, you never win.”

That mindset was evident in India’s batting approach throughout the tournament, with the team consistently aiming for totals well beyond traditional T20 benchmarks.

“For too long we played cricket aiming for 160–170,” Gambhir said. “I would rather get all out for 110 than play 160–170 cricket. High risk, high reward is very important in this format.”

The coach is equally clear about what truly matters in a

team sport: collective success over personal milestones.

“Stop celebrating milestones,” Gambhir said bluntly. “Celebrate trophies.”

Despite their contrasting personalities, both men insist their partnership worked because they were always aligned in their thinking.

“We were always on the same page,” Surya said. “I don’t remember a time when we argued about a player.”

Gambhir echoed the sentiment, calling Surya a “phenomenal leader” who made his job easier.

Another cornerstone of their leadership has been trust. Gambhir believes players must feel secure even during lean patches.

“You pick a team on trust and faith, not on hope,” he said. “When you pick someone on trust and faith, you don’t lose it after four or five games.”

That approach has helped create a dressing room environment that is relaxed yet fiercely focused, where players feel free to express themselves and take risks.

For Gambhir, the objective was never simply to preserve India’s success. “I don’t believe in inheriting anything,” he said. “I believe in creating something.”

REMAINS NATION’S SPORTING TEMPLATE

T20 WC glory shows why cricket is showing India the way

S KANNAN



Other sports in India need to study cricket’s model and grow.

Ramji Srinivasan, former India strength and conditioning coach

What unfolded in Ahmedabad on Sunday offered a compelling counterargument. It was nothing short of mesmerising—cricket that transported fans into a fantasy world.

For those who believe India still have ground to make up in Test cricket, that debate can wait for another day.

Winning back-to-back T20 World Cups is, without doubt, something magical. The achievement has drawn praise from all quarters, including political circles. Equally important is recognising how cricket’s

growth in India has been driven by the efforts of the BCCI and its affiliated state associations. Last week offered another striking example. Jammu and Kashmir clinched the Ranji Trophy, defeating Karnataka in Hubli. The victory highlighted how the sport continues to expand beyond traditional power centres. The growth of state-level T20 leagues has also helped create an ecosystem that many sporting nations envy.

Speaking to *Millennium Post*, former India strength and conditioning coach Ramji Srinivasan—who was part of the support staff during India’s 2011 ICC Cricket World Cup triumph—offered an important perspective. “This win again proves Indian cricket is doing things right from the state level,” Srinivasan said. “And for those who argue that cricket’s dominance hurts other sports in India, that’s simply not true.”

Based in Chennai and currently working with the Tamil Nadu Cricket Association, Srinivasan believes other disciplines should learn from cricket’s structure. “Other sports in India need to study cricket’s model and grow. We have a vast pool of coaches, players and support staff. Olympics disciplines should take a cue,” he said.

From bench to brilliance, life comes full circle for Samson

NEW DELHI: Batting great Sunil Gavaskar said life has come full circle for Sanju Samson, who rose from being a fringe player to emerge as the player of the tournament with three defining knocks in India’s knockout games during their historic T20 World Cup campaign.

Samson delivered explosive knocks in the last three matches of the T20 World Cup, including the semifinal against

England and the final against New Zealand.

“Life has come full circle for Sanju Samson. Before the 2026 T20 World Cup, he had a terrible series against New Zealand. He was dropped, then after the T20 World Cup started, he got a chance to play against Namibia, but his knock wasn’t enough to keep his spot.

“He next played directly against Zimbabwe in the Super 8, but his real redemption



Samson, who was the reserve wicketkeeper in the previous edition with Rishabh Pant, began against West Indies

in a virtual quarter-final,” said Gavaskar.

“He played a flamboyant innings and looked in complete control. We know how skilled Sanju is. But to perform in a virtual quarter-final, in the semi-final against England and then in the all-important final against New Zealand is not easy.”

Samson, who was the reserve wicketkeeper in the previous edition with Rishabh

Pant preferred in the XI, seemed destined for a similar fate this time as well after a poor build-up series against New Zealand in which he managed just 46 runs from five T20Is at an average of 9.20.

He was dropped with Ishan Kishan preferred for the wicketkeeper’s role, but the team had a rethink after India were on the brink of exit following a group-stage loss to South Africa.

AGENCIES



e-Procurement Cell
Office of the Executive Engineer,
Building Construction Department, Building Division, Jamshedpur

e-Procurement Notice
Tender Ref. No.-BCD/EE,Building Div. Jamshedpur-65/2025-26, Dated:- 09.03.2026

क्र०	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
1.	Renovation of Old Girls Hostel Sambhavi at M.G.M. Medical College, Jamshedpur.	1,60,42,300.00	10 Months
i	वेबसाईट पर निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि	30.03.2026	
ii	बिड प्रारंभ के लिए अंतिम तिथि / समय	06.04.2026 को अपराह्न 3:00 बजे	
iii	निविदा खोलने की तिथि / समय	07.04.2026 को अपराह्न 3:00 बजे	
iv	निविदा प्रकाशित करने वाले कार्यालय का नाम एवं पता	Office of the Executive Engineer, Building Construction Department, Building Division, Jamshedpur. E-mail : eebcd@jamshedpur@gmail.com	
v	प्रोक्योरमेंट पदाधिकारी का सम्पर्क संख्या	9748415659	
vi	हेल्पलाइन सेल का हेल्पलाइन संख्या	9748415659	

● इस निविदा से संबंधित किसी भी प्रश्न की सूचना / बदलाव / संशोधन का अवलोकन <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in/j> किया जा सकता है।
Note : New Updated UCAN Registration is mandatory for all Bidders.

Nodal Officer,
e-Procurement Cell,
Office of the Executive Engineer,
Building Construction Department,
Building Division, Jamshedpur

PR 374460 (Building) 25-26 (D)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Gopi Chand, S/o. Sh. Chanderpal, R/o.: RZF-171, Nihal Vihar, Nangloi, Delhi Also at: R/o. RZE-185, Nihal Vihar, Nangloi, Delhi-110041** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.451/2019 U/S 498A/406/34 IPC** registered at **P.S Nihal Vihar, Outer District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest thereupon issued stating that the said accused **Gopi Chand** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Gopi Chand** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Gopi Chand**, accused of **FIR No.451/2019 U/S 498A/406/34 IPC, P.S Nihal Vihar, Outer District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **10.04.2026**.

By Order, Ms. Divyashree Raina,
Judicial Magistrate First Class (West),
Mahila Court-01, Room No. 252,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi.

DP/3047/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

C.G. Police Housing Corporation, Raipur
Head Office - P.H.Q. Campus, North Block, Sector-19, Nava Raipur, Atal Nagar (C.G.) Phone 0771 - 2331800
Tender No./ 1936 to 1938/CGPHC/Bldg/2026 Dated 05/02/2006
TENDER NOTICE (1st Call)

Online Tenders are invited according to key dates for Construction of Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+1) (08 Nos.) at Baloda Bazar (District Police), Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+1) (08 Nos.) at Dhamtari (District Police), Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+1) (08 Nos.) at Gariyaband (District Police), Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+1) (08 Nos.) at Maliasamund (District Police), Head Constable / Constable Houses (P+6) (48 Nos.) at 1st Bn. Bhillai, Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+1) (08 Nos.) at 3rd Bn. Amleshwar, Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+1) (08 Nos.) at 7th Bn. Bhillai, N.G.O. Houses (G+2) (12 Nos.) at Rajnandgaon (District Police), Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+1) (08 Nos.) at 8th Btl. Rajnandgaon, Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+1) (08 Nos.) & N.G.O. Houses (G+2) (12 Nos.) at Kabirdham (District Police) , Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+1) (08 Nos.) at 17th Btl. Kabirdham, N.G.O. Houses (G+2) (12 Nos.) at Balod (District Police) , Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+1) (08 Nos.) at 14th Bn. Dhanora, Balod, Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+1) (08 Nos.) at 21st Bn. Balod, Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+1) (08 Nos.) & N.G.O. Houses (G+2) (12 Nos.) at Bemetara (District Police), N.G.O. Houses (G+2) (12 Nos.) at Bilaspur (District Police) , Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+1) (08 Nos.) & (G+2) (36 Nos.) at 11th Bn. Janjigar Champa, Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+1) (08 Nos.) & (G+2) (36 Nos.) & N.G.O. Houses (G+2) (12 Nos.) at Mungelli (District Police) , Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+2) (24 Nos.) & N.G.O. Houses (G+2) (12 Nos.) at Surguja (District Police) , Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+2) (48 Nos.) at 12th Bn. Ramanujganj, Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+2) (48 Nos.) at 18th Bn. Korla, Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+2) (24 Nos.) & N.G.O. Houses (P+6) (24 Nos.) at Jagdalpur (District Police), Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+2) (48 Nos.) at 5th Bn. Jagdalpur, Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+2) (36 Nos.) at 19th Bn. Jagdalpur, Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+2) (36 Nos.) at 22nd Bn. Kanker, N.G.O. Houses (G+2) (12 Nos.) at Sukma (District Police), Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+2) (36 Nos.) at Gaurala Pendra Marwahi (District Police) & 84 Head Constable / Constable Flats (G+2) at Manendragarh - Bharatpur- Chirmiri (District Police), 84 Hc/C Flats (G+2), 8 Hc/C Flats (G+1) & 24 Ngo Flats (G+2) At Kanker (District Police), 96 Hc/C Flats (G+2) & 24 Ngo Flats (0+2) At Mohla-Manpur-Ambagarh Chowki (District Police), 84 Hc/C Flats (G+2) & 24 Ngo Flats (G+2) At Sarangarh - Bilaigarh (District Police), 72 Hc/C Flats (G+2) & 24 Ngo Flats (G+2) At Khairagarh— Chulikhadan-Gandai (Distt. Police), 48 Hc/C Flats (G+2) & 24 Ngo Flats (G+2) At 10th Bn. Surajpur, 72 Hc/C Flats (G+2) & 08 Hc/C Flats (G+1) At 13th Bn. Korba, 60 Hc/C Flats (G+2) & 12 Ngo Plats (G+2) At Janjigar - Champa (Distt. Police), 48 Hc/C Flats (G+2) & 12 NGO Flats (G+2) at Surajpur (Distt. Police), 48 Hc/C Flats (G+2) & 12 Ngo Flats (G+2) At Ctjw Kanker, 60 Hc/C Flats (G+2) & 12 Ngo Flats (G+2) At Bolrapur (Distt. Police), 156 Hc/C Flats (G+2) & 36 Ngo Flats (G+2) At Narayanpur (Distt. Police), 48 Hc/C Flats (G+2) & 12 Ngo Flats (G+2), & 24 Ngo Flats (P+6) At Jashpur (Distt. Police), 48 Hc/C Flats (P+6) & 8 Ngo Flats (G+1) , & 24 Ngo Flats (P+6) At V.I.P. Vahini Mano, 24 Hc/C Flats (G+2), 48 Hc/C Flats (P+6) & 12 Ngo Flats (G+2) At 6th Bn Raigarh, 16 Hc/C Flats (G+1), 132 Hc/C Flats (G+2) & 12 Ngo Flats (G+2) At Bijapur (District Police), 96 Hc/C Flats (G+2),At Kondagaon (Distt. Police), 96 Hc/C Flats (G+2),At 16th Bn Narayanpur, 60 Hc/C Flats (G+2),At Raigarh (Distt Police), 48 Hc/C Flats (G+2) & 12 Ngo (G+2),At Korba (Distt Police) & 156 Hc/C /Constabel Flats (G+2) at Sukma (District Police), 96 H.C./Constabel Flats (G+2) at Bilaspur (District Police), 12 N.G.O. (G+2) & 72 H.C./Constable Flats (G+2) at SP STF Durg , 12 N.G.O. (G+2) & 72 H.C./Constable Flats (G+2) at Gariyaband (District Police), 12 N.G.O. (G+2) & 48 H.C./Constable Flats (G+2) at Dhamtari (District Police) and 72 H.C./Constable Flats (G+2) at V.I.P. Vahini Mano online tender invitation Tender System No. - 185359 to 185369, 185371 to 185386, 186431 to 186445, 186447, 186448, 186450 to 186460 Which are available from 10.03.2026 (10:30 am) to 06.04.2026 (17:30pm) in CGPHC Portal <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> along with other details. samvad 47126/5 Managing Director

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Santosh Mathur, S/o Ramdas, R/o 1) C-56, Gautam Colony, Narela, Delhi, 2) Permanent Address Village Dalelganj, PS Kayamganj, District Farukhabad, UP** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 953/2022, dated 22.12.2022, U/s 279/427 IPC, P.S. Narela Industrial Area, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Santosh Mathur** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Santosh Mathur** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Santosh Mathur** accused of **FIR No. 953/2022, dated 22.12.2022, U/s 279/427 IPC, P.S. Narela Industrial Area, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.05.2026**.

By Order - Ms. Jyoti Nain
Judicial Magistrate First Class
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/2931/ON/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **(1) Rahul @ Robert, S/o: Ramesh, R/o: H. No. D-33, Har Swaroop Colony, Fatehpur Bari Delhi (2) Abhishek @ Bhola, S/o: Ram Gopal, R/o: H.No. 12/287, Madan Giri Ambekar Nagar, Delhi (3) Akshay @ Vishal @ Monu, S/o: Jaipal, R/o: H. No. A-239, Jhuggi No. 02, Lal Kuan Pul Prahladh Pur Dauri (4) Shivam, S/o: Bhoore Singh, R/o: H. No. 427, JJ Colony Madan Pur Khadar, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No.: 404/2022 U/s 324/186/147/148/149/353/332/34 IPC P.S.: Hari Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **(1) Rahul @ Robert (2) Abhishek @ Bhola (3) Akshay @ Vishal @ Monu (4) Shivam**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **(1) Rahul @ Robert (2) Abhishek @ Bhola (3) Akshay @ Vishal @ Monu (4) Shivam**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **(1) Rahul @ Robert (2) Abhishek @ Bhola (3) Akshay @ Vishal @ Monu (4) Shivam**, accused of **FIR No.: 404/2022 U/s 324/186/147/148/149/353/332/34 IPC P.S.: Hari Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.04.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Moksha Bains
JMFC-II, Room No 31,
Tis Hajari Court, Delhi

DP/3009/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Ltd. (Arcil)
Acting in its capacity as Trustee of various Arcil Trusts
Arcil office : The Ruby, 10th floor, 29, Senapati Bapat Marg, Dadar (West), Mumbai - 400 028.
Website : <https://auction.arcil.co.in>; CIN - U65999MH2002PLC134884

PUBLIC NOTICE FOR SALE THROUGH ONLINE E-AUCTION IN EXERCISE OF THE POWERS UNDER THE SECURITIZATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002 (SARFAESI ACT) READ WITH RULES 6, 8 & 9 OF SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES, 2002

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and to the Borrower (s) / Guarantor (s) / Mortgageor (s), in particular, that the below described immovable property/ies mortgaged / charged to the Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Limited, acting in its capacity as Trustee of various Arcil Trusts ("ARCIL") (pursuant to the assignment of financial asset vide registered Assignment Agreements), will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is", "Whatever there is" and "Without recourse basis" by way of online e - auction, for recovery of outstanding dues of together with further interest, charges and costs etc., as detailed below in terms of the provisions of the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 ("Act") read with Rules 6, 8 and 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 ("Rules").

Name of the Borrower / Co - Borrowers / Guarantor/s / Mortgage/s	LAN No. & Selling Bank	Trust Name	Outstanding Amount As Per SARFAESI Notice Dated 02.07.2021 and 25.03.2022 Respectively	Possession Type and Date	Date Of Inspection	Type of Property	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Reserve Price	Date & Time of E-Auction
Borrower : 1. JITENDER SINGH 2. GEETA KAIM 3. TRIVENDAR SINGH	Loan Account No. HHLNOD00384624 Edelweiss Asset Reconstruction Company Ltd. ("EARC")	Arcil - CPS - IV - Trust	Rs. 26,52,664/- (Rupees Twenty Six Lakh Fifty Two Thousand Six Hundred Sixty Four only) as on 26.06.2021 + further Interest thereon + Legal Expenses	Physical possession on 30.08.2025	Will be arranged on request	Freehold 386 sq. ft. (super built - up area)	Rs. 2,00,300/- (Rupees Two Lakh Three Hundred only)	Rs. 20,03,000/- (Rupees Twenty Lakh Three Thousand only)	On 27.03.2026 at 12:00 P.M.
Description of the Secured Asset being auctioned : FLAT NO. FF 3, FIRST FLOOR, RIGHT HAND SIDE MIDDLE, PLOT NO. B 3, DLF DILSHAD EXTN. II, GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH.									
Borrower : 1. DAMODAR PRASAD VERMA 2. HEMANTI DEVI	Loan Account No. HHLDP00491488 Edelweiss Asset Reconstruction Company Ltd. ("EARC")	Arcil - CPS - IV - Trust	Rs. 10,93,501.42/- (Rupees Ten Lakh Ninety Three Thousand Five Hundred One and Paise Forty Two Only) as on 02.03.2022 + further Interest thereon + Legal Expenses	Physical possession on 08.10.2025	Will be arranged on request	Flat - 370 sq. ft. (super built - up area)	Rs. 92,000/- (Rupees Nine Thousand Two Hundred only)	Rs. 9,20,000/- (Rupees Nine Lakh Twenty Thousand only)	On 27.03.2026 at 12:30 P.M.
Description of the Secured Asset being auctioned : FLAT NO. UGF - 2, HAVING BUILT - UP AREA 370 SQ. FT., UPPER GROUND FLOOR, FRONT LEFT - HAND SIDE, PLOT NO. A-7, KHASRA NO. 211, RAIL ROAD, VILL. SADULLABAD, LONI, GHAZIABAD - 201102, UTTAR PRADESH.									
Pending Litigations known to ARCIL				Nil		Encumbrances / Dues known to ARCIL		Nil	
Last Date for submission of Bid				Same day 2 hours before Auction		Bid Increment amount :		As mentioned in the BID document	
Demand Draft to be made in name of :				ARCIL - CPS - IV - TRUST		Payable at par			
RTGS details				ARCIL - CPS - IV - TRUST, Trust Account No. - 57500001353101, HDFC Bank Limited, Branch: Kamala Mill, Mumbai, IFSC Code : HDFC0000542.					
Name of Contact person & number				Sanjeev Godara - 0124-6910910; +91 70654 51024 (auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com).					
Terms and Conditions : 1. The Auction Sale is being conducted through e-auction through the website https://auction.arcil.co.in and as per the Terms and Conditions of the Bid Document, and as per the procedure set out therein. 2. The Authorized Officer ("AO") / ARCIL shall not be held responsible for internet connectivity, network problems, system crash down, power failure etc. 3. At any stage of the auction, the "AO" may accept / reject / modify / cancel the bid / offer or post - pone the Auction without assigning any reason thereof and without any prior notice. 4. The successful purchaser / bidder shall bear any statutory dues, taxes, fees payable, applicable GST on the purchase consideration, stamp duty, registration fees, etc. that is required to be paid in order to get the secured asset conveyed / delivered in his / her / its favour as per the applicable law. 5. The intending bidders should make their own independent enquiries / due diligence regarding encumbrances, title of secured asset and claims / rights / dues affecting the secured assets, including statutory dues, etc., prior to submitting their bid. The auction advertisement does not constitute and will not constitute any commitment or any representation of ARCIL. The Authorized Officer of ARCIL shall not be responsible in any way for any third - party claims / rights / dues. 6. The particulars specified in the auction notice published in the newspaper have been stated to the best of the information of the undersigned; however undersigned shall not be responsible / liable for any error, misstatement or omission. 7. The Borrower / Guarantors / Mortgageors, who are liable for the said outstanding dues, shall treat this Sale Notice as a notice under Rules 8 and 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, about the holding of the above mentioned auction sale. 8. In the event, the auction scheduled hereinabove fails for any reason whatsoever, ARCIL has the right to sell the secured asset by any other methods under the provisions of Rule 8(5) of the Rules and the Act.									
Place : GHAZIABAD Date : 26.02.2026				Sd/- Authorized Officer Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Ltd.					

Arcil
Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Ltd. (Arcil)
Acting in its capacity as Trustee of various Arcil Trusts
Arcil office : The Ruby, 10th floor, 29, Senapati Bapat Marg, Dadar (West), Mumbai - 400 028.
Website : <https://auction.arcil.co.in>; CIN - U65999MH2002PLC134884

PUBLIC NOTICE FOR SALE THROUGH ONLINE E-AUCTION IN EXERCISE OF THE POWERS UNDER THE SECURITIZATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002 (SARFAESI ACT) READ WITH RULES 6, 8 & 9 OF SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES, 2002

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and to the Borrower (s) / Guarantor (s) / Mortgageor (s), in particular, that the below described immovable property/ies mortgaged / charged to the Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Limited, acting in its capacity as Trustee of various Arcil Trusts ("ARCIL") (pursuant to the assignment of financial asset vide registered Assignment Agreements), will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is", "Whatever there is" and "Without recourse basis" by way of online e - auction, for recovery of outstanding dues of together with further interest, charges and costs etc., as detailed below in terms of the provisions of the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 ("Act") read with Rules 6, 8 and 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 ("Rules").

Name of the Borrower / Co - Borrowers / Guarantor/s / Mortgage/s	LAN No. & Selling Bank	Trust Name	Outstanding Amount As Per SARFAESI Notice Dated 16.08.2023 And 07.04.2021 Respectively	Possession Type and Date	Date Of Inspection	Type of Property and Area	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Reserve Price	Date & Time of E-Auction
Borrower : 1. AMAN SHARMA 2. AKHILESH KUMAR 3. AKASH SHARMA	Loan Account No. HHLVAS00262534 Sammaan Capital Limited (SCL) [formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Limited]	Arcil - Trust - 2025 - 007	Rs. 11,48,476.52/- (Rupees Eleven Lakh Forty Eight Thousand Four Hundred Seventy Six and Paise Fifty Two Only) as on 14.08.2023 + further Interest thereon + Legal Expenses	Physical possession on 04.04.2025	Will be arranged on request	Free Hold - 556 Sq. Ft. (built - up area)	Rs. 1,65,000/- (Rupees One Lakh Fifty Five Thousand only)	Rs. 16,50,000/- (Rupees Sixteen Lakh Fifty Thousand only)	On 26.03.2026 at 05:45 P.M.
Description of the Secured Asset being auctioned : FLAT NO. G - 2, ON GROUND FLOOR (MIG), ADMEASURING 556 SQ. FT. (BUILT - UP AREA), WITHOUT ROOF RIGHT, REAR SIDE, SITUATED ON PLOT NO. A - 49, DLF DILSHAD EXTN. - II, GHAZIABAD - 201005, UTTAR PRADESH. BOUNDED BY : EAST : COMMON PASSAGE / FLAT NO. G - 1; WEST : PROPERTY OF OTHERS; NORTH : PLOT NO. A - 48; SOUTH : PLOT NO. A - 50.									
Pending Litigations known to ARCIL				Nil		Encumbrances / Dues known to ARCIL		Nil	
Last Date for submission of Bid				Same day 2 hours before Auction		Bid Increment amount :		As mentioned in the BID document	
Demand Draft to be made in name of :				ARCIL - TRUST - 2025 - 007		Payable at par			
RTGS details				ARCIL - TRUST - 2025 - 007, Trust Account No. - 57500001510599, HDFC Bank Limited, Branch : Kamla Mills, Mumbai, IFSC Code : HDFC0000542.					
Name of Contact person & number				Sanjeev Godara - 0124-6910910; +91 70654 51024 (auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com).					
Borrower : 1. KRISHNA KANT SINGH 2. MOTI RANI DEVI 3. SAURABH KUMAR MISHRA (GUARANTOR)	Loan Account No. HHLNOD00401200 Sammaan Capital Limited ("SCL") [formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Limited]	Arcil - CPS - II - Trust	Rs. 19,76,607/- (Rupees Nineteen Lakh Seventy Six Thousand Six Hundred Seven Only) as on 31.03.2021 + further Interest thereon + Legal Expenses	Physical possession on 31.07.2023	Will be arranged on request	Freehold 270 sq. ft. (super built - up area)	Rs. 1,07,000/- (Rupees One Lakh Seven Thousand Only)	Rs. 10,70,000/- (Rupees Ten Lakh Seven Thousand Only)	On 26.03.2026 at 02:00 P.M.
Description of the Secured Asset being auctioned : All that part and parcel of the property bearing FLAT NO. SF - 2 (M. I. G.) ADMEASURING 270 SQ. FT. (SUPER BUILT - UP AREA) ON 2ND FLOOR (WITH ROOF RIGHTS), LEFT HAND BACK SIDE CONSTRUCTED UPON PLOT NO. F - 39, "BLOCK - K" SITUATED IN SLF VEHAR, LONI, GHAZIABAD - 200111, UTTAR PRADESH, BOUNDARIES : EAST : OTHER'S PROPERTY; WEST : COMMON PASSAGE AND STAIRS; NORTH : FLAT NO. SF-3 (L.I.G.) AND PLOT NO. F - 40; SOUTH : OTHER'S PROPERTY.									
Pending Litigations known to ARCIL				Nil		Encumbrances / Dues known to ARCIL		Nil	
Last Date for submission of Bid				Same day 2 hours before Auction		Bid Increment amount :		As mentioned in the BID document	
Demand Draft to be made in name of :				ARCIL - CPS - II - TRUST		Payable at par			
RTGS details				ARCIL - CPS - II - TRUST, Trust Account No. - 57500001169088, HDFC Bank Limited, Branch : Kamla Mill, Mumbai, IFSC Code : HDFC0000542.					
Name of Contact person & number				Sanjeev Godara - 0124-6910910; +91 70654 51024 (auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com).					
Terms and Conditions : 1. The Auction Sale is being conducted through e-auction through the website https://auction.arcil.co.in and as per the Terms and Conditions of the Bid Document, and as per the procedure set out therein. 2. The Authorized Officer ("AO") / ARCIL shall not be held responsible for internet connectivity, network problems, system crash down, power failure etc. 3. At any stage of the auction, the "AO" may accept / reject / modify / cancel the bid / offer or post - pone the Auction without assigning any reason thereof and without any prior notice. 4. The successful purchaser / bidder shall bear any statutory dues, taxes, fees payable, applicable GST on the purchase consideration, stamp duty, registration fees, etc. that is required to be paid in order to get the secured asset conveyed / delivered in his / her / its favour as per the applicable law. 5. The intending bidders should make their own independent enquiries / due diligence regarding encumbrances, title of secured asset and claims / rights / dues affecting the secured assets, including statutory dues, etc., prior to submitting their bid. The auction advertisement does not constitute and will not constitute any commitment or any representation of ARCIL. The Authorized Officer of ARCIL shall not be responsible in any way for any third - party claims / rights / dues. 6. The particulars specified in the auction notice published in the newspaper have been stated to the best of the information of the undersigned; however undersigned shall not be responsible / liable for any error, misstatement or omission. 7. The Borrower / Guarantors / Mortgageors, who are liable for the said outstanding dues, shall treat this Sale Notice as a notice under Rules 8 and 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, about the holding of the above mentioned auction sale. 8. In the event, the auction scheduled hereinabove fails for any reason whatsoever, ARCIL has the right to sell the secured asset by any other methods under the provisions of Rule 8(5) of the Rules and the Act.									
lace : GHAZIABAD Date : 25.02.2026				Sd/- Authorized Officer Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Ltd.					



RAIL COACH FACTORY, KAPURTHALA

On-line bids are invited by PCMM, RCF on behalf of President of India for following items:-

S. No.	Tender No. and Due Date	Description	Quantity (Nos./Sets)	EMD (Rs.)
1.	02261065A/07.04.2026	Harness of LHB EOG Non-AC LSCN		13,66,790/-
2.	05251597A/06.04.2026	Roof Arch. PL No. 33555000	9786 Nos.	4,39,990/-
3.	14261002/31.03.2026	Fire Extinguisher	2104 Nos.	2,09,380/-
4.	12261019/26.03.2026	Set of FRP Modular Toilet for MEMU/TC 3-Phase Coaches	125 Sets	6,69,970/-
5.	17261016/30.03.2026	Set of Ladders for LHB SCN Coaches	295 Sets	3,06,180/-
6.	02261089/30.03.2026	9 KVA, 750 V AC/415 V AC/190 V AC, 3-Phase, Dry Type Distribution Transformer for LHB Type Non-AC Coaches		7,35,380/-
7.	05261127/30.03.2026	Partition Frame	38 Set	1,53,350/-

1. For details and making on-line bids, visit website <http://ireps.gov.in>. Drawings/specifications, wherever required can be downloaded from RCF website <http://www.rcf.indianrailways.gov.in>. Class III-b digital signature certificate required for on-line bidding, can be obtained from licensed certifying agencies listed at <http://www.cca.gov.in>.
2. Tenders will close at 14.25 Hrs. on due date and tenders will be opened at 14.30 hrs. Tender at Sl. No. 1 to 6 will be opened at RCF Kapurthala and Sl. No. 7 at Tilak Bridge, New Delhi. 3. For queries, contact IREPS Helpdesk at 011-24102855, 011-24105180 or RCF Helpdesk at 011-23378658.
Note: GST Number of RCF is 03AAAGM0289C1ZT. All the suppliers are advised to quote this in dispatch documents for the supplies made by them. **PCMM**

CORRIGENDUM

Tenderers may please note the following changes in 1. Tender No. 05251643 for Procurement of Set of Under Frame Items for LHB SCN Coaches, Due date to be read as 18.03.2026 instead of 03.03.2026. 2. Tender No. 17261006, Due date to be read as 12.03.2026 instead of 05.03.2026. 3. Tender No. 17261004, Due date to be read as 12.03.2026 instead of 05.03.2026. 4. Tender No. 02251676 for Fire Barrier Sealant, (i) Due date to be read as 25.03.2026 instead of 20.03.2026, (ii) Quantity to be read as 6511 Nos. instead of 2338 Nos., (iii) EMD to be read as Rs. 2,84,270.00 instead of Rs. 1,02,080.00. All other terms & conditions will remain the same. **PCMM**

R.O. No. 140-S/2025-26 Dated 09.03.2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Mohammad Aamir, S/o: Mohammad Maksood Ahmad, R/o: House No. E-49 / K-34, Janta Majdoor Colony, P.S. Welcome, North-East, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 387/2005, U/s: 21/22/25/29 NDPS Act**, registered at **P.S.: Shastri Park, Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Mohammad Aamir**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Mohammad Aamir**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Mohammad Aamir, FIR No. 387/2005, U/s: 21/22/25/29 NDPS Act**, registered at **P.S.: Shastri Park, Delhi**, is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.04.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Puneet Pahwa
Special Judge (NDPS) Additional Sessions Judge
District North-East, Room No. 63, 4th Floor
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/2934/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person Namley **Suraj S/o Sh. Umed Singh R/o H.No. 308, Phirni Road, Talab Wali Gali, Village Harewali, Delhi**, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 712/2021 U/s 392/397/34 IPC.**, has been registered at **P.S. Narela Ind. Area, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Suraj** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Suraj** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Suraj** of under **FIR No. 712/2021 U/s 392/397/34 IPC.**, has been, registered at **P.S. Narela Ind. Area, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.04.2026**.

By Order
Vandana
ASJ-02 (North), Room No. 202
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/2930/ON/2026
(Court Notice)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sanjay, S/o: Daya Shankar, R/o: C34A Shashi Garden Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 146/2010 U/s 420/406 IPC P.S.: Kalyanpuri, New Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sanjay**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sanjay**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sanjay**, accused of **FIR No.: 146/2010 U/s 420/406 IPC P.S.: Kalyanpuri, New Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **09.04.2026**.

By Order
Prigya Gupta
(CJM) East Court No. 29
Karkardooma, Delhi

DP/3000/ED/2

I WAS BLOWN away: Aparshakti Khurana ON WORKING with Dimple Kapadia

The actor said he watched
and learnt from legends
on set of 'Jab Khuli Kitaab'

“Given the body
of work both Pankaj
sir and Dimple
ma'am have, if they
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it means it is special.
Working on 'Jab
Khuli Kitaab' was all
about watching the
legends and learning
from them”



ANINDITA ACHARYA

For actor Aparshakti Khurana, working with stalwarts like Pankaj Kapur, Dimple Kapadia and Saurabh Shukla was more than he could have asked for. He was just excited to share screen space with the legends he grew up watching. In fact, the 'Berlin' actor was instantly transported to the 'Ram Lakhan' days when he first saw Kapadia walking onto the sets of 'Jab Khuli Kitaab'. "Someone like me, coming from Chandigarh, could never think of having a life in Mumbai. Till today, the songs of 'Ram Lakhan' are so vivid in my memory. I remember the first day I saw her on the set of 'Jab Khuli Kitaab', I was absolutely blown away by her beauty and attitude," smiled the actor. Aparshakti is a crucial part of Shukla's directorial, 'Jab Khuli Kitaab', a mature love story with Kapur and Kapadia in the lead on 'Zee5'. It was only in 2016 that Apar-

shakti made his debut in 'Dangal'. But it didn't take long for this Chandigarh-born actor to prove his mettle as an actor. Be it 'Badrinath Ki Dulhania', 'Stree', 'Luka Chuppi', 'Helmet', 'Bhediya', 'Jubilee' or 'Berlin', Aparshakti made a space for himself in Bollywood. And now, the actor is elated to work with legends in 'Jab Khuli Kitaab'. In fact, he made sure he learnt anything and everything he could from the seniors on the set. "Given the body of work both Pankaj sir and Dimple ma'am have, if they said yes to a project, it means it is special. So, I had to be a part of it. Working on 'Jab Khuli Kitaab' was all about watching the legends and learning from them," he said. Now, Shukla is known as an actor par excellence and Aparshakti couldn't stop praising how he gave him complete freedom to proceed with his character as a lawyer. "We often work with directors who are not actors themselves, but they act out and show how they want the scene to be. So, everyone has their own process. If I ever write or direct something, I might have that urge to do it and show how to do it. But Saurabh sir gave us so much freedom and trusted us," he said. In 'Jab Khuli Kitaab', the director sets out to highlight the perils of a decades-old marriage and the issues of trust within a marriage. Just like Shukla showed 'trust' in the actors, Aparshakti believes 'trust' is the fulcrum of any relationship. "Mutual trust is the most important," said the actor, who was in Ahmedabad for the India-New Zealand T20 final match.

BEHIND THE SCENES OF 'SUBEDAAR'

Anil pushes his limits for the film's gruelling action

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Anil Kapoor proves yet again that he doesn't age - he upgrades. In the recently released 'Prime Original' movie 'Subedaar', Kapoor delivers one of the most physically demanding performances of his career, stepping into the fierce and formidable shoes of Subedaar Arjun Maurya, a character many are already calling the 'Desi John Wick'. A newly released behind-the-scenes video captures Kapoor in a never-before-seen action avatar, pushing himself through gruelling rehearsals, weightlifting drills and high-risk stunt sequences to bring the character to life. Director Suresh Triveni reflected on the relentless preparation that went into the film, revealing how Kapoor chose to perform most of the physically taxing sequences himself across a demanding 44-day action schedule. Recalling some of the toughest moments on set, Triveni shared, "At his age, that level of physical activity is incredible. I



A newly released behind-the-scenes video captures the actor in a never-before-seen action avatar

used to feel guilty. His effort and passion were so inspiring for the entire team. Physically, one of the most challenging days was shooting in the ravines and a street sequence where he had to perform through constant noise and chaos. There's a staircase scene where he is rigged and pulled through an actual structure and he did it all by himself." He further recalled how Kapoor nonchalantly teased him about the sequence, saying, "He told me, 'Tu karle na. Main toh karunga hi'. We were extremely careful because it was a real staircase, but he did it and we got the shot. But I had to do it first." Speaking about preparing for the role, Anil Kapoor shared, "Subedaar" demanded a level of

physical and emotional commitment that pushed me in ways I hadn't experienced in a long time. I trained hard, rehearsed extensively and chose to perform many of the action sequences myself because the character needed that authenticity. When you play someone like Subedaar Arjun Maurya, the strength can't be a costume you wear; it has to come from within. Every bruise, every long day on set was worth it to bring that honesty to the screen." Directed by Suresh Triveni, 'Subedaar' is produced by Vikram Malhotra, Anil Kapoor and Triveni under 'Opening Image Films', in association with 'Anil Kapoor Film & Communication Network'. The film also stars Radhikka Madan alongside a stellar ensemble including Saurabh Shukla, Aditya Rawal, Faisal Malik, Khushboo Sundar and Mona Singh in pivotal roles.

RLFF to open with 'Testament of Ann Lee'

NEW DELHI: 'Testament of Ann Lee', starring Amanda Seyfried, will serve as the opening film at the third edition of the upcoming Red Lorry Film Festival, the organisers announced. The film is directed by Mona Fastvold and features Seyfried in the role of Ann Lee. The historical drama explores the life of Ann Lee, founder of the Shaker religious movement, tracing her journey from persecution in England to becoming a spiritual leader in the United States. It premiered in competition at the Venice International Film Festival. PTI



I was very stubborn and foolish: Kajol



Kajol recently opened up about her upcoming projects and shared her views on taking a sabbatical during the peak of her career. The actress expressed that she has been exploring several ideas and scripts. However, nothing is finalised as of now. In an interview with 'Mid-Day', Kajol opened up about unconventional choices she made in her journey. She played a negative role in the film 'Gupt: The Hidden Truth'. Later, she stepped away from movies during the peak of her career. Talking about the same, Kajol said, "I feel I was very stubborn

and foolish and I was proved right, fortunately. But I see so many women doing this all the time without being given any awards for it. I have made my own decisions and I stand by them. I am grateful that all my eccentricities have been loved." In the same conversation, Kajol talked about her next projects. She revealed that she hadn't signed anything yet. The actress said, "I'm listening to a lot of scripts. I have two or three things that I'm working on. But I have nothing concrete to tell you." The actress also opened up about choosing a project wisely. Apart from the story, the actress also gives importance to seeing who she is working with while signing a film. She said, "It's important to me that I work with people whom I can relate to and talk to. You spend 50 days with people (on the set) and if you don't like them, those 50 days can feel like 500!" The actress was last seen in the film 'Sarazameen', directed by Kayoze Irani. AGENCIES

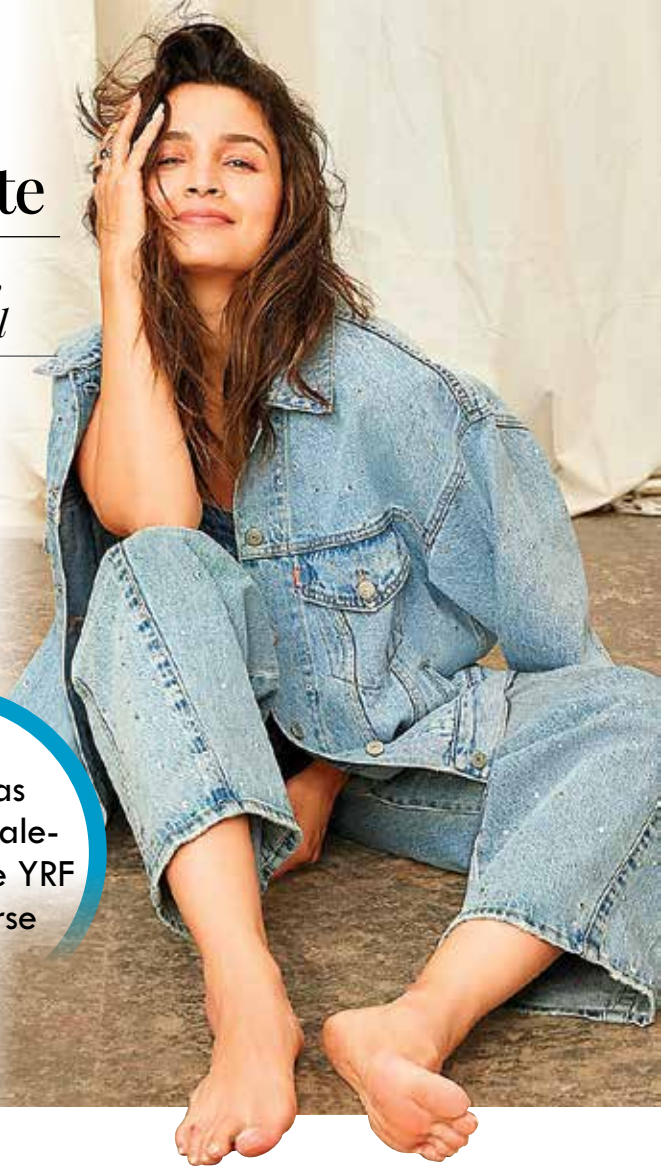


ALIA BHATT'S 'ALPHA' finally gets a release date

The film also stars Sharvari,
Anil Kapoor and Bobby Deol

OUR CORRESPONDENT

After much speculation, finally Alia Bhatt-starrer 'Alpha', which is touted as the first female-led film in the YRF Spy Universe, has a new release date. The film, which also stars Sharvari, Anil Kapoor and Bobby Deol, was initially scheduled to release on Christmas last year, but now, 'Yash Raj Films' announced that the action entertainer will hit theatres on July 10, 2026! 'Alpha' marks Alia's first film with 'Yash Raj Films'. It is also the first female-led out-and-out action film of India, with Alia and Sharvari teaming up to pull off action sequences that audiences have never seen a girl do before on screen. Alia and Sharvari will go toe-to-toe against Bobby in this brutal showdown. 'Alpha' is directed by Shiv Rawail, who had previously directed YRF's global hit series 'The Railway Men'. The film has been produced by Aditya Chopra.



'Alpha' is touted as the first female-led film in the YRF Spy Universe

Wouldn't want to go back to that time: Katie Leung

She talked about working in the 'Harry Potter' films

LOS ANGELES: Katie Leung, known for her role in the acclaimed film series 'Harry Potter', said she wouldn't want to return to those days as she didn't know who she was and would easily get influenced by what people around her would say. Leung made her acting debut in 2005 with 'Harry Potter and the Goblet of Fire', where she essayed the role of Cho Chang. She later went on to feature in 'Harry Potter and the Order of the Phoenix', 'Harry Potter and the Half-Blood Prince' and 'Harry Potter and the Deathly Hallows: Part 2'. "I was so young at the time and I was so easily influenced by what people would say about me because I didn't know who I was," she told 'Entertainment Tonight' in an interview.

The actress, whose latest work is 'Bridgerton', said she joined the Regency-era romance series with a healthy focus on her work. "So, I've come into 'Bridgerton' having a really healthy focus on the work. I'm so glad I'm here. I wouldn't want to go back to that time (working on 'Harry Potter'). Not because I had a bad time or anything, but it's just really nice when you know who you are and I'm still figuring that out, but I'm a bit closer," she said. The 'Harry Potter' series is

currently in development by 'HBO Max'. Asked what the actress would wish to the artist essaying her character in the series, Leung said it's important to 'just be themselves'. "For anybody really, (whatever) stage in their life, (my advice is) just to be themselves, because that's what makes them unique... And to not let the kind of noise of other people get to you, because what you have already is a gift and you should really just try and hold onto that," she said. PTI

The actress, whose latest work is 'Bridgerton', said she joined the Regency-era romance series with a healthy focus on her work